जब तक आपको यह परीक्षण पुस्तिका खोलने को न कहा जाए तब तक न खोलें

T.B.C.: FIAS-SFG26 **परीक्षण पुस्तिका अनुक्रम**

परीक्षण पुस्तिका

सामान्य अध्ययन

A

पूर्णांक : 100 **समय: एक घंटे**

अनुदेश

1. परीक्षा प्रारम्भ होने के तुरन्त बाद, आप इस परीक्षण पुस्तिका की पड़ताल अवश्य कर लें कि इसमें कोई बिना छपा, फटा या छूटा हुआ पृष्ठ अथवा प्रश्नांश, आदि न हो। यदि ऐसा है, तो इसे सही परीक्षण पुस्तिका से बदल लीजिए।
2. **कृपया ध्यान रखें कि OMR उत्तर-पत्रक में, उचित स्थान पर, रोल नम्बर और परिक्षण पुस्तिका अनुक्रम A, B, C या D को, ध्यान से एवं बिना किसी चूक या विसंगति के भरने और कूटबद्ध करने की जिम्मेदारी उम्मीदवार की है। किसी भी प्रकार की चूक/विसंगति की स्थिति में उत्तर -पत्रक निरस्त कर दिया जाएगा ।**
3. इस परीक्षण पुस्तिका पर साथ में दिए गए कोष्ठक में आपको अपना अनुक्रमांक लिखना है। परीक्षण पुस्तिका पर **और कुछ न** लिखें।

नाम:
ईमेल:
मोबाइल:

4. इस परीक्षण पुस्तिका में **50** प्रश्नांश (प्रश्न) हैं। प्रत्येक प्रश्नांश **अंग्रेज़ी और हिंदी** में छपा है। प्रत्येक प्रश्नांश में चार प्रत्युत्तर (उत्तर) दिए गए हैं। इनमें से एक प्रत्युतर को चुन लें, जिसे आप उत्तर-पत्रक पर अंकित करना चाहते हैं। यदि आपको ऐसा लगे कि एक से अधिक प्रत्युत्तर सही हैं, तो उस प्रत्युत्तर को अंकित करें जो आपको सर्वोत्तम लगे। किसी भी स्थिति में, प्रत्येक प्रश्नांश के लिए **केवल एक ही** प्रत्युत्तर चुनना है।
5. आपको अपने सभी प्रत्युत्तर अलग से दिए गए उत्तर-पत्रक पर ही अंकित करने हैं। उत्तर-पत्रक में दिए गए निर्देश देखिए।
6. ***सभी*** प्रश्नांशों *के अंक समान हैं।*
7. इससे पहले कि आप परीक्षण पुस्तिका के विभिन्न प्रश्नांशों के प्रत्युत्तर उत्तर-पत्रक पर अंकित करना शुरू करें, आपको प्रवेश प्रमाण-पत्र के साथ प्रेषित अनुदेशों के अनुसार कुछ विवरण उत्तर-पत्रक में देने हैं।
8. आप अपने सभी प्रत्युत्तरों को उत्तर-पत्रक में भरने के बाद तथा परीक्षा के समापन पर केवल उत्तर-पत्रक अधीक्षक को सौंप दें। आपको अपने साथ परीक्षण पुस्तिका ले जाने की अनुमति है।
9. कच्चे काम के लिए पत्रक परीक्षण पुस्तिका के अंत में संलग्न है।
10. **गलत उत्तरों के लिए दंड :**

वस्तुनिष्ठ प्रश्न-पत्रों में उम्मीदवार द्वारा दिए गए गलत उत्तरों के लिए दंड दिया जाएगा।

(i) प्रत्येक प्रश्न के लिए चार वैकल्पिक उत्तर हैं। उम्मीदवार द्वारा प्रत्येक प्रश्न के लिए दिए गए एक गलत उत्तर के लिए प्रश्न हेतु नियत किए गए अंकों का एक-तिहाई दंड के रूप में काटा जाएगा।

(ii) यदि कोई उम्मीदवार एक से अधिक उत्तर देता है, तो इसे गलत उत्तर माना जाएगा, यद्यपि दिए गए उत्तरों में से एक उत्तर सही होता है, फिर भी उस प्रश्न के लिए उपर्युक्तानुसार ही, उसी तरह का दंड दिया जाएगा।

(iii) यदि उम्मीदवार द्वारा कोई प्रश्न हल नहीं किया जाता है, अर्थात उम्मीदवार द्वारा उत्तर नहीं दिया जाता है, तो उस प्रश्न के लिए कोई दंड नहीं दिया जाएगा।

नोट: प्रश्न का उत्तर दें तथा अभ्यर्थी आत्मविश्वास स्तर (100% / 75% / 50% / 0%) का उपयोग करके उत्तर के प्रति अपनी निश्चितता का स्तर दर्ज कर सकते हैं। आप प्रत्येक प्रश्न के नीचे उपयुक्त आत्मविश्वास स्तर का चयन कर सकते हैं। इससे उन प्रश्नों की पुनरावृत्ति (रिवीजन) में सहायता मिलेगी, जिनमें उत्तर सही होने के बावजूद आप अनिश्चित थे।

जब तक आपको यह परीक्षण पुस्तिका खोलने को न कहा जाए तब तक न खोलें

Q.1) Consider the following airports:
1. Donyi Polo Airport
2. Kushinagar International Airport
3. Vijayawada International Airport

In the recent past, which of the above have been constructed as Greenfield project?
a) 1 and 2 only
b) 2 and 3 only
c) 1 and 3 only
d) 1, 2 and 3

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.2) With reference to Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) Sector, consider the following statements:
I. Globally, MSMEs are responsible for over 50 per cent of the total global employment.
II. In India, MSMEs are the second-largest employer after agriculture
III. In India, MSMEs contribute to over 45% of the country's exports.

Which of the statements given above are correct?
a) I and II only
b) I, II and III
c) I and III only
d) II and III only

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.3) The Backward Value Added in Exports (BVAX) ratio measures:
a) the share of exported components in gross import.
b) the share of total domestic value added in gross exports.
c) the share of foreign value added in gross exports.
d) the share of total value of agricultural raw materials in gross exports.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.4) Which of the following statements best describes the term 'servicification' in the manufacturing sector?
a) The process of replacing manual labor in production lines with automated robotic services.
b) The increasing utilization of services in manufacturing production and post-production value addition.
c) The gradual replacement of the traditional manufacturing activities by the service sector.
d) The outsourcing of the core manufacturing activities to the foreign countries.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.5) With reference to India's steel sector, consider the following statements:
Statement I: India is the world's second-largest producer of crude steel.
Statement II: India is self-sufficient in iron ore and coking coal, which are primary raw materials used in crude steel production.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?
a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I
c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct
d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.6) Consider the following ports:
I. Jawaharlal Nehru Port, Maharashtra
II. V. O. Chidambaranar Port, Tamil Nadu
III. Vizhinjam International Seaport, Kerala

Presently, which of the above is/are deepwater Container Transhipment Port in India?
a) I only
b) II and III only
c) III only
d) I, II and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.1) निम्नलिखित विमानपत्तनों पर विचार कीजिए :
1. डोनी पोलो विमानपत्तन
2. कुशीनगर अंतरराष्ट्रीय विमानपत्तन
3. विजयवाड़ा अंतरराष्ट्रीय विमानपत्तन

हाल ही में, उपर्युक्त में से किनका निर्माण नवीन (ग्रीनफील्ड) परियोजनाओं के रूप में किया गया है?
a) केवल 1 और 2
b) केवल 2 और 3
c) केवल 1 और 3
d) 1, 2 और 3

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.2) सूक्ष्म, लघु और मध्यम उद्यम (MSMEs) क्षेत्र के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:
I. वैश्विक स्तर पर, MSMEs कुल वैश्विक रोजगार के 50 प्रतिशत से अधिक के लिए उत्तरदायी हैं।
II. भारत में, MSMEs कृषि के बाद दूसरे सबसे बड़े नियोक्ता हैं।
III. भारत में, MSMEs देश के निर्यात में 45% से अधिक का योगदान देते हैं।

उपर्युक्त में से कौन-से कथन सही हैं?
a) केवल I और II
b) I, II और III
c) केवल I और III
d) केवल II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.3) निर्यात में बैकवर्ड वैल्यू एडेड इन एक्सपोर्ट्स (BVAX) अनुपात क्या मापता है?
a) सकल आयात में निर्यातित घटकों का हिस्सा।
b) सकल निर्यात में कुल घरेलू मूल्य संवर्धन का हिस्सा।
c) सकल निर्यात में विदेशी मूल्य संवर्धन का हिस्सा।
d) सकल निर्यात में कृषि संबंधी कच्चे माल के कुल मूल्य का हिस्सा।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.4) विनिर्माण क्षेत्र में 'सेवाकरण (Servicification)' शब्द का सबसे उपयुक्त वर्णन निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा है?
a) उत्पादन लाइनों में मैनुअल श्रम को स्वचालित रोबोटिक सेवाओं से प्रतिस्थापित करने की प्रक्रिया।
b) विनिर्माण उत्पादन और उत्पादनोत्तर मूल्यवर्धन में सेवाओं का बढ़ता उपयोग।
c) पारंपरिक विनिर्माण गतिविधियों का सेवा क्षेत्र द्वारा क्रमिक प्रतिस्थापन।
d) मुख्य विनिर्माण गतिविधियों का विदेशों को आउटसोर्स करना।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.5) भारत के इस्पात क्षेत्र के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:
कथन I: भारत कच्चे इस्पात का विश्व का दूसरा सबसे बड़ा उत्पादक है।
कथन II: भारत लौह अयस्क और कोकिंग कोयले के मामले में आत्मनिर्भर है, जो कच्चे इस्पात उत्पादन में प्रयुक्त प्राथमिक कच्चे माल हैं।

उपर्युक्त कथनों के संबंध में निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा सही है?
a) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं और कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या करता है।
b) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं, लेकिन कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या नहीं करता है।
c) कथन I सही है, लेकिन कथन II सही नहीं है।
d) कथन I सही नहीं है, लेकिन कथन II सही है।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.6) निम्नलिखित बंदरगाहों पर विचार कीजिए:
I. जवाहरलाल नेहरू पोर्ट, महाराष्ट्र
II. वी. ओ. चिदंबरनार पोर्ट, तमिलनाडु
III. विझिंजम अंतरराष्ट्रीय समुद्री बंदरगाह, केरल

वर्तमान में, उपर्युक्त में से कौन-सा/से भारत में गहरे जल का कंटेनर ट्रांसशिपमेंट पोर्ट है/हैं?
a) केवल I
b) केवल II और III
c) केवल III
d) I, II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.7) With reference to the 'Orange Economy', recently seen in the news, consider the following activities:
I. Animation and Visual Effects (VFX)
II. Traditional tribal crafts and handloom
III. Poultry processing through automation
IV. Live Music Concerts
Which of the above activities are considered as part of the Orange Economy?
a) I, II and IV only
b) I and IV only
c) II and III only
d) I, II, III and IV

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.8) With reference to the Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF), consider the following statements:
I. It is a statutory body.
II. It acts as an apex body to provide high-level strategic direction of scientific research in the country as per recommendations of the National Education Policy.
III. Research, Development and Innovation Fund (RDIF) is a Special Purpose Fund under ANRF
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I and III only
b) II only
c) II and III only
d) I, II and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.9) Consider the following statements:
Statement I: Investments made by mutual funds in units of Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs) are classified as equity-related instruments.
Statement II: REIT units represent direct ownership of immovable property, similar to purchasing physical real estate.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?
a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct, but Statement II does not explain Statement I
c) Statement I is correct, but Statement II is not correct
d) Statement I is not correct, but Statement II is correct

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.10) In the context of defence technology, Sonobuoys, recently seen in the news, are:
a) Unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs) designed for coastal surveillance.
b) Electro-mechanical acoustic devices used for detecting submarines.
c) Underwater mines equipped with motion sensors for naval defence.
d) Surface-to-air missile systems deployed on naval destroyers.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.11) Capital deepening refers to
a) going for more fixed capital per worker
b) emphasis on social overhead capital
c) constant capital-output ratio
d) increasing capital-output ratio

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.12) Consider the following scenario in a country X - While insurance density has risen steadily to $97 in FY 2025 the insurance penetration has declined to 3.7 per cent.
The above scenario best reflects-
a) the average insurance premium paid per person in a year has increased while the percentage of insurance premiums to GDP in a year has decreased.
b) the total number of unique policyholders in the country has increased, but the value of the average premium per policy has declined significantly.
c) the average life insurance premiums paid per person in a year has increased while the percentage of non-life insurance premiums to GDP in a year has decreased.
d) rate of growth of the country's population has exceeded the rate of growth of total insurance premiums collected, while GDP growth remains constant

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.7) हाल ही में समाचारों में देखी गई 'ऑरेंज इकोनॉमी' के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित गतिविधियों पर विचार कीजिए:
I. एनीमेशन एण्ड विजुअल इफेक्ट्स (VFX)
II. पारंपरिक जनजातीय शिल्प और हैंडलूम
III. स्वचालन के माध्यम से पोल्ट्री प्रसंस्करण
IV. लाइव म्यूजिक कॉन्सर्ट
उपर्युक्त में से कौन-सी गतिविधियाँ ऑरेंज इकोनॉमी का हिस्सा मानी जाती हैं?
a) केवल I, II और IV
b) केवल I और IV
c) केवल II और III
d) I, II, III और IV

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.8) अनुसंधान नेशनल रिसर्च फाउंडेशन (ANRF) के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:
I. यह एक वैधानिक निकाय है।
II. यह राष्ट्रीय शिक्षा नीति की सिफारिशों के अनुसार देश में वैज्ञानिक अनुसंधान को उच्च-स्तरीय रणनीतिक दिशा प्रदान करने के लिए एक शीर्ष निकाय के रूप में कार्य करता है।
III. अनुसंधान, विकास और नवाचार कोष (RDIF) ANRF के अंतर्गत एक विशेष प्रयोजन कोष है।
उपर्युक्त में से कौन-सा/से कथन सही है/हैं?
a) केवल I और III
b) केवल II
c) केवल II और III
d) I, II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.9) निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:
कथन I: म्यूचुअल फंडों द्वारा रियल एस्टेट इन्वेस्टमेंट ट्रस्ट्स (REITs) की इकाइयों में किए गए निवेश को इक्विटी-संबंधित साधनों के रूप में वर्गीकृत किया जाता है।
कथन II: REIT इकाइयाँ अचल संपत्ति के प्रत्यक्ष स्वामित्व का प्रतिनिधित्व करती हैं, जो भौतिक रियल एस्टेट खरीदने के समान है।
उपर्युक्त कथनों के संबंध में निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा सही है?
a) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं और कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या करता है।
b) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं, लेकिन कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या नहीं करता है।
c) कथन I सही है, लेकिन कथन II सही नहीं है।
d) कथन I सही नहीं है, लेकिन कथन II सही है।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.10) रक्षा प्रौद्योगिकी के संदर्भ में, हाल ही में समाचारों में देखे गए सोनोबॉय (Sonobuoys) क्या हैं?
a) तटीय निगरानी के लिए डिज़ाइन किए गए मानव रहित हवाई वाहन (UAVs)।
b) पनडुब्बियों का पता लगाने के लिए प्रयुक्त विद्युत-यांत्रिक ध्वनिक उपकरण।
c) नौसैनिक रक्षा के लिए गति संवेदकों से सुसज्जित जल के नीचे बिछाई जाने वाली बारूदी सुरंगें।
d) नौसैनिक विध्वंसकों पर तैनात सतह से वायु में मार करने वाली मिसाइल प्रणालियाँ।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.11) पूँजी सघनीकरण (Capital deepening) क्या उल्लिखित करता है?
a) प्रति कामगार अधिक नियत पूँजी होने देना
b) सामाजिक बँधी पूँजी पर बल देना
c) स्थिर पूँजी-उत्पाद अनुपात
d) बढ़ रहा पूँजी-उत्पाद अनुपात

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.12) किसी देश X में निम्नलिखित स्थिति पर विचार कीजिए - वित्त वर्ष 2025 में बीमा घनत्व (Insurance Density) लगातार बढ़कर $97 हो गया है, जबकि बीमा पैठ घटकर 3.7 प्रतिशत हो गई है।
उपर्युक्त स्थिति सबसे उपयुक्त रूप से क्या दर्शाती है?
a) एक वर्ष में प्रति व्यक्ति भुगतान किया जाने वाला औसत बीमा प्रीमियम बढ़ गया है, जबकि एक वर्ष में GDP के सापेक्ष बीमा प्रीमियम का प्रतिशत घट गया है।
b) देश में अद्वितीय पॉलिसीधारकों की कुल संख्या बढ़ गई है, लेकिन प्रति पॉलिसी औसत प्रीमियम का मूल्य उल्लेखनीय रूप से घट गया है।
c) एक वर्ष में प्रति व्यक्ति भुगतान किया जाने वाला औसत जीवन बीमा प्रीमियम बढ़ गया है, जबकि एक वर्ष में GDP के सापेक्ष गैर-जीवन बीमा प्रीमियम का प्रतिशत घट गया है।
d) देश की जनसंख्या की वृद्धि दर, एकत्र किए गए कुल बीमा प्रीमियम की वृद्धि दर से अधिक हो गई है, जबकि GDP वृद्धि स्थिर बनी हुई है।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.13) The Government of India has consolidated 29 labour laws into four comprehensive Labour Codes. In this context consider the following:

I. Trade Unions Act, 1926
II. The Employees' State Insurance Act, 1948
III. Industrial Employment (Standing Orders) Act 1946
IV. The Factories Act, 1948
V. The Contract Labour (Regulation and Abolition) Act, 1970

The relevant provisions of how many of the above acts/laws have been consolidated into the Industrial Relations Code, 2020?

a) Only two
b) Only three
c) Only four
d) All the five

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.14) With reference to Indian Economy, consider the following:

I. Petroleum Refinery Production
II. Natural Gas production
III. Coal production
IV. Electricity generation

Which of the following is the correct descending order of the industries based on their weightage under the Index of Eight core industries (as of December 2025)?

a) I-IV-II-III
b) IV-I-III-II
c) I-IV-III-II
d) IV-I-II-III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.15) Which of the following statements are correct regarding the recently launched 'Cali Fund'?

I. It will support the actions that are aimed at meeting the objectives of Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (KMGBF).
II. At least 50 per cent of the resources of the Cali Fund will be allocated to fulfill the needs of indigenous peoples and local communities.
III. The Fund will receive mandatory contributions from private sector entities that are benefitting from global biodiversity.
IV. It will be jointly managed and hosted by the World Bank and the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN).

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a) I and II only
b) III and IV only
c) I, II and III only
d) I, II, III and IV

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.16) In the context of Indian economy, consider the following statements:

Statement I: Presently, India is the largest mobile phone manufacturer globally.

Statement II: Production Linked Incentive Scheme has encouraged major smartphone companies to shift their production to India

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I
c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct
d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.17) With reference to Credit Guarantee Scheme for Startups (CGSS), consider the following statements:

I. It would help in providing collateral free debt funding to eligible startups.
II. Venture Debt Funds (VDFs) under SEBI registered Alternative Investment Funds are eligible as lending/investing institutions under the scheme.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.13) भारत सरकार ने 29 श्रम कानूनों को चार व्यापक श्रम संहिताओं में एकीकृत कर दिया है। इस संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित पर विचार कीजिए:

I. ट्रेड यूनियंस अधिनियम, 1926
II. कर्मचारी राज्य बीमा अधिनियम, 1948
III. औद्योगिक रोजगार (स्थायी आदेश) अधिनियम, 1946
IV. कारखाना अधिनियम, 1948
V. ठेका श्रम (विनियमन और उन्मूलन) अधिनियम, 1970

उपर्युक्त में से कितने अधिनियमों/कानूनों के प्रासंगिक प्रावधानों को औद्योगिक संबंध संहिता, 2020 (Industrial Relations Code, 2020) में समेकित किया गया है?

a) केवल दो
b) केवल तीन
c) केवल चार
d) सभी पाँच

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.14) भारतीय अर्थव्यवस्था के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित पर विचार कीजिए:

I. पेट्रोलियम रिफाइनरी उत्पादन
II. प्राकृतिक गैस उत्पादन
III. कोयला उत्पादन
IV. विद्युत उत्पादन

आठ कोर उद्योगों के सूचकांक (Index of Eight Core Industries) के अंतर्गत भारांक (weightage) के आधार पर (दिसंबर 2025 के अनुसार) उद्योगों का सही अवरोही क्रम कौन-सा है?

a) I-IV-II-III
b) IV-I-III-II
c) I-IV-III-II
d) IV-I-II-III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.15) हाल ही में शुरू किए गए 'कैली फंड (Cali Fund)' के संबंध में निम्नलिखित कथनों में से कौन-से सही हैं?

I. यह कुनमिंग-मॉन्ट्रियल वैश्विक जैव विविधता फ्रेमवर्क (KMGBF) के उद्देश्यों को पूरा करने के लिए लक्षित कार्यों का समर्थन करेगा।
II. कैली फंड के संसाधनों का कम से कम 50 प्रतिशत भाग स्वदेशी लोगों और स्थानीय समुदायों की आवश्यकताओं को पूरा करने के लिए आवंटित किया जाएगा।
III. इस फंड को निजी क्षेत्र की संस्थाओं से अनिवार्य योगदान प्राप्त होगा, जो वैश्विक जैव विविधता से लाभान्वित होती हैं।
IV. इसका संयुक्त रूप से प्रबंधन और मेजबानी विश्व बैंक और प्रकृति संरक्षण के लिए अंतर्राष्ट्रीय संघ (IUCN) द्वारा किया जाएगा।

नीचे दिए गए कूट का उपयोग करके सही उत्तर चुनिए:

a) केवल I और II
b) केवल III और IV
c) केवल I, II और III
d) I, II, III और IV

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.16) भारतीय अर्थव्यवस्था के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

कथन I: वर्तमान में, भारत वैश्विक स्तर पर मोबाइल फोन का सबसे बड़ा निर्माता है।

कथन II: उत्पादन आधारित प्रोत्साहन योजना (PLI) ने प्रमुख स्मार्टफोन कंपनियों को अपना उत्पादन भारत में स्थानांतरित करने के लिए प्रोत्साहित किया है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों के संबंध में निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा सही है?

a) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं और कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या करता है।
b) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं, लेकिन कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या नहीं करता है।
c) कथन I सही है, लेकिन कथन II सही नहीं है।
d) कथन I सही नहीं है, लेकिन कथन II सही है।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.17) स्टार्टअप्स के लिए क्रेडिट गारंटी योजना (CGSS) के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. यह पात्र स्टार्टअप्स को "संपार्श्विक-मुक्त" ऋण वित्तपोषण उपलब्ध कराने में सहायता करेगी।
II. सेबी-पंजीकृत वैकल्पिक निवेश कोष (AIFs) के अंतर्गत वेंचर डेट फंड (VDFs) इस योजना के अंतर्गत ऋण/निवेश संस्थानों के रूप में पात्र हैं।

उपर्युक्त में से कौन-सा/से कथन सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I
b) केवल II
c) I और II दोनों
d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.18) In the context of India, consider the following three entities:

I. A is a private limited company established 8 years ago, engaged in the development of a localized E-commerce platform.

II. B is a private limited company established 13 years ago and spend most of its money on research and development (R&D) activities and owns a novel intellectual property (IP).

III. C is a Multi State Cooperative Society registered under Multi-State Cooperative Societies Act, 2002 established 2 years ago, providing tech-enabled supply chain solutions for rural dairy farmers.

If the maximum annual turnover of the above entities never crossed 150 crore since their inception, then which of the following entities is/are eligible to be recognized as startup or deep tech startup by Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)?

a) I only
b) I and II only
c) I, II and III
d) II only

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.19) Consider the following:

I. Computer software or programme
II. Cinematograph films
III. Mathematical concepts
IV. Original Literary Works

How many of the above are provided Copyright protection in India under Copyright Act, 1957?

a) Only one
b) Only two
c) Only three
d) All the four

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.20) With reference to production of coffee in India, consider the following statements:

I. India is the world's third largest producer of coffee.

II. India produces a much higher quantity of Arabica Coffee as compared to Robusta.

III. Karnataka is the largest coffee producing State accounting for more than 50% of India's total coffee production.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) II only
b) II and III
c) III only
d) I and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.21) Which one among the following defines flexi workers in India?

a) Formal contract staff employed through organised contract
b) Informal sector employees working in urban areas
c) Agricultural labour migrating to urban areas
d) Regular salaried workers working in registered companies

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.22) In the context of India, consider the following:

I. Legal services rendered by the lawyer in a court case.

II. Free medical service provided by a doctor in a rural area.

III. Supply of electricity by the government owned discom.

Which of the above is/are **not** included under the definition of the Services under the Consumer Protection Act, 2019?

a) I only
b) II and III only
c) I and II only
d) I, II and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.18) भारत के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित तीन संस्थाओं पर विचार कीजिए:

I. A एक प्राइवेट लिमिटेड कंपनी है जिसकी स्थापना 8 वर्ष पहले हुई थी और यह एक स्थानीयकृत ई-कॉमर्स प्लेटफॉर्म के विकास में संलग्न है।

II. B एक प्राइवेट लिमिटेड कंपनी है जिसकी स्थापना 13 वर्ष पहले हुई थी और यह अपने अधिकांश धन को अनुसंधान एवं विकास (R&D) गतिविधियों पर व्यय करती है तथा इसके पास एक नवीन बौद्धिक संपदा (IP) है।

III. C एक बहु-राज्य सहकारी समिति है, जो बहु-राज्य सहकारी समितियां अधिनियम, 2002 के अंतर्गत पंजीकृत है, जिसकी स्थापना 2 वर्ष पहले हुई थी और यह ग्रामीण डेयरी किसानों के लिए प्रौद्योगिकी-सक्षम आपूर्ति श्रृंखला समाधान प्रदान करती है।

यदि उपर्युक्त संस्थाओं का अधिकतम वार्षिक टर्नओवर उनकी स्थापना के बाद से कभी भी ₹150 करोड़ से अधिक नहीं हुआ, तो निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सी संस्था/संस्थाएँ उद्योग और आंतरिक व्यापार संवर्द्धन विभाग (DPIIT) द्वारा स्टार्टअप या डीप टेक स्टार्टअप के रूप में मान्यता प्राप्त करने के लिए पात्र है/हैं?

a) केवल I
b) केवल I और II
c) I, II और III
d) केवल II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.19) निम्नलिखित पर विचार कीजिए:

I. कंप्यूटर सॉफ्टवेयर या प्रोग्राम
II. सिनेमैटोग्राफ फिल्में
III. गणितीय अवधारणाएँ
IV. मौलिक साहित्यिक कृतियाँ

उपर्युक्त में से कितनों को भारत में कॉपीराइट अधिनियम, 1957 के अंतर्गत कॉपीराइट संरक्षण प्रदान किया जाता है?

a) केवल एक
b) केवल दो
c) केवल तीन
d) सभी चार

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.20) भारत में कॉफी उत्पादन के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. भारत विश्व का तीसरा सबसे बड़ा कॉफी उत्पादक है।

II. भारत में रोबस्टा (Robusta) की तुलना में अरेबिका (Arabica) कॉफी का उत्पादन अधिक होता है।

III. कर्नाटक भारत का सबसे बड़ा कॉफी उत्पादक राज्य है, जो भारत के कुल कॉफी उत्पादन का 50% से अधिक योगदान देता है।

उपर्युक्त में से कौन-सा/से कथन सही है/हैं?

a) केवल II
b) II और III
c) केवल III
d) I और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.21) निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा, भारत में फ्लेक्सी कामगारों (flexi workers) को परिभाषित करता है?

a) संगठित संविदा के माध्यम से नियोजित औपचारिक संविदा कर्मचारी
b) शहरी क्षेत्रों में काम करने वाले अनौपचारिक क्षेत्र के कर्मचारी
c) शहरी क्षेत्रों में प्रवास करने वाले कृषि श्रमिक
d) रजिस्ट्रीकृत कंपनियों में काम करने वाले नियमित वेतनभोगी कामगार

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.22) भारत के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित पर विचार कीजिए:

I. किसी न्यायालय मामले में वकील द्वारा प्रदान की गई कानूनी सेवाएँ।

II. ग्रामीण क्षेत्र में डॉक्टर द्वारा प्रदान की गई निःशुल्क चिकित्सा सेवा।

III. सरकारी स्वामित्व वाली वितरण कंपनी द्वारा विद्युत की आपूर्ति।

उपर्युक्त में से कौन-सा/से उपभोक्ता संरक्षण अधिनियम, 2019 के अंतर्गत सेवाओं की परिभाषा में शामिल नहीं है/हैं?

a) केवल I
b) केवल II और III
c) केवल I और II
d) I, II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.23) The Public Private Partnership Appraisal Committee (PPPAC), responsible for appraising infrastructure projects undertaken through the Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model, functions under which one of the following departments of the Government of India?
a) Department of Financial Services
b) Department of Revenue
c) Department of Expenditure
d) Department of Economic Affairs

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.24) In the context of Intellectual Property Rights (IPRs), compulsory licensing refers to:
a) An authorization granted by the government to someone else i.e., a third party to produce a patented product without the consent of the patent owner.
b) The patent holder through its own discretion offers third parties the license to produce, market and distribute a patented product.
c) Automatic permission to produce a patented product by anyone after the expiry of the patent term.
d) A mechanism under which a startup can register its trademark for free.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.25) With reference to Indian economy, consider the following statements regarding the royalty rate on critical minerals:
I. The Union Government determines the royalty rates on critical minerals.
II. Royalty on critical minerals is levied under the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I Nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.26) With reference to the Indian Ports Act, 2025, consider the following statements:
I. It establishes the Maritime State Development Council (MSDC) as a statutory body.
II. The Act empowers the Union Government to fix/decide the tariffs at both major and non-major ports.
III. Each state government will constitute a Dispute Resolution Committee to adjudicate disputes between ports including major ports.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) I and III only
c) I and II only
d) None of the above

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.27) The 'Frontier Technologies Readiness Index', which assesses countries' preparedness to adopt emerging technologies, is released by-
a) United Nations Office for Digital and Emerging Technologies (ODET)
b) United Nations Trade and Development (UNCTAD)
c) World Economic Forum (WEF)
d) Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD)

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.28) Consider the following pairs of Airports of India and their significance:

Airport	**Significance**
I. Navi Mumbai International Airport	India's largest airport in terms of area.
II. Cochin International Airport	World's first airport to operate entirely on solar power.
III. Kempegowda International Airport	India's first airport to achieve 'water-positive' status.

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?
a) Only one
b) Only two
c) All the three
d) None

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.23) पब्लिक प्राइवेट पार्टनरशिप मूल्यांकन समिति (PPPAC), जो PPP मॉडल के अंतर्गत संचालित अवसंरचना परियोजनाओं का मूल्यांकन करती है, भारत सरकार के किस विभाग के अंतर्गत कार्य करती है?

a) वित्तीय सेवा विभाग
b) राजस्व विभाग
c) व्यय विभाग
d) आर्थिक कार्य विभाग

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.24) बौद्धिक संपदा अधिकार (IPRs) के संदर्भ में अनिवार्य लाइसेंसिंग का क्या अर्थ है?

a) सरकार द्वारा किसी अन्य पक्ष को पेटेंट धारक की अनुमति के बिना पेटेंट उत्पाद के उत्पादन की अनुमति देना
b) पेटेंट धारक द्वारा स्वयं की इच्छा से किसी तीसरे पक्ष को उत्पादन, विपणन और वितरण का लाइसेंस देना
c) पेटेंट अवधि समाप्त होने के बाद किसी भी व्यक्ति को स्वतः उत्पादन की अनुमति मिल जाना
d) ऐसा तंत्र जिसके अंतर्गत कोई स्टार्टअप अपना ट्रेडमार्क निःशुल्क पंजीकृत कर सकता है

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.25) भारतीय अर्थव्यवस्था के संदर्भ में महत्वपूर्ण खनिजों पर रॉयल्टी दर के संबंध में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. केंद्रीय सरकार महत्वपूर्ण खनिजों पर रॉयल्टी दर निर्धारित करती है।
II. महत्वपूर्ण खनिजों पर रॉयल्टी, खनिज और खनन (विकास एवं विनियमन) अधिनियम, 1957 के अंतर्गत लगाई जाती है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I
b) केवल II
c) I और II दोनों
d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.26) भारतीय बंदरगाह अधिनियम, 2025 के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. यह समुद्री राज्य विकास परिषद (MSDC) को एक वैधानिक निकाय के रूप में स्थापित करता है।
II. यह अधिनियम केंद्र सरकार को प्रमुख और गैर-प्रमुख दोनों बंदरगाहों पर शुल्क निर्धारित करने का अधिकार देता है।
III. प्रत्येक राज्य सरकार प्रमुख बंदरगाहों सहित बंदरगाहों के बीच विवादों के समाधान के लिए एक विवाद समाधान समिति गठित करेगी।

नीचे दिए गए कूट का उपयोग करके सही उत्तर चुनिए।

a) केवल I
b) केवल I और III
c) केवल I और II
d) उपर्युक्त में से कोई नहीं

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.27) उभरती प्रौद्योगिकियों को अपनाने के लिए देशों की तैयारी का आकलन करने वाला 'फ्रंटियर टेक्नोलॉजीज रेडीनेस इंडेक्स' किसके द्वारा जारी किया जाता है?

a) संयुक्त राष्ट्र डिजिटल और उभरती प्रौद्योगिकी कार्यालय (ODET)
b) संयुक्त राष्ट्र व्यापार और विकास सम्मेलन (UNCTAD)
c) विश्व आर्थिक मंच (WEF)
d) आर्थिक सहयोग एवं विकास परिषद (OECD)

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.28) भारत के निम्नलिखित हवाई अड्डों और उनकी विशेषताओं के युग्मों पर विचार कीजिए:

हवाई अड्डा	विशेषता
I. नवी मुंबई अंतरराष्ट्रीय हवाई अड्डा	क्षेत्रफल के आधार पर भारत का सबसे बड़ा हवाई अड्डा
II. कोचीन अंतरराष्ट्रीय हवाई अड्डा	पूर्णतः सौर ऊर्जा से संचालित होने वाला विश्व का पहला हवाई अड्डा
III. केम्पेगौड़ा अंतरराष्ट्रीय हवाई अड्डा	भारत का पहला "वाटर पॉजिटिव" हवाई अड्डा

उपर्युक्त में से कितने युग्म सही सुमेलित हैं?

a) केवल एक
b) केवल दो
c) सभी तीन
d) कोई नहीं

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.29) With reference to the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI), consider the following statements:

I. It is a statutory body under the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways.

II. It has recently launched the Bee Corridor initiative to reduce the ecological stress faced by honeybees and other pollinators.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.30) With reference to India's naval defence technology, the 'INS Surat', recently in the news, is:

a) India's first indigenously built nuclear-powered submarine.
b) India's first stealth frigate under Project 17A.
c) India's first anti-submarine warfare shallow watercraft.
d) India's first warship to be equipped with artificial intelligence (AI) solutions.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.31) Which of the following statements with regard to the 'National Manufacturing Mission' is/are correct?

1. It covers small, medium and large industries.
2. It will support cleantech manufacturing.
3. It will facilitate promotion of employment opportunities in labour-intensive sectors.

Select the answer using the code given below.

a) 1 only
b) 2 only
c) 1 and 2 only
d) 1, 2 and 3

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.32) In the context of the financial sector, what does the term 'Bancassurance' refer to?

a) An agreement under which banks provide loans to insurance companies for underwriting risks.
b) A partnership between banks and insurance companies to sell insurance products through bank branches.
c) A scheme where insurance companies provide time deposit services similar to banks.
d) A process of reinsurance where a bank takes over the liabilities of an insolvent insurance provider to protect policyholders.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.33) Which of the following statements best describes 'Braesse's Paradox'?

a) Increasing road capacity in urban areas to reduce congestion can actually worsen overall traffic congestion.
b) Expanding industrial zones to boost production can reduce overall industrial output due to increased competition for limited resources.
c) Technological progress that makes a resource cheaper or more efficient to use often leads to an increase in demand for that resource.
d) Countries endowed with abundant natural resources may experience slower economic growth and weaker institutions.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.34) With reference to Research and Development expenditure in India, consider the following statements:

I. India's Gross Expenditure on Research and Development (GERD) as a percentage of Gross Domestic Product is less than 1 per cent.

II. The private sector accounts for more than 75 per cent of India's total Research and Development expenditure.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.29) भारतीय राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग प्राधिकरण (NHAI) के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. यह सड़क परिवहन और राजमार्ग मंत्रालय के अंतर्गत एक वैधानिक निकाय है।

II. इसने हाल ही में मधुमक्खी गलियारा (Bee कॉरिडोर) पहल प्रारंभ की है ताकि मधुमक्खियों और अन्य परागणकर्ताओं पर पड़ने वाले पारिस्थितिक दबाव को कम किया जा सके।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I

b) केवल II

c) I और II दोनों

d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.30) भारत की नौसैनिक रक्षा प्रौद्योगिकी के संदर्भ में हाल ही में समाचारों में रहा 'INS सूरत' क्या है?

a) भारत की पहली स्वदेश निर्मित परमाणु ऊर्जा चालित पनडुब्बी

b) प्रोजेक्ट 17A के अंतर्गत भारत का पहला स्टील्थ फ्रिगेट

c) भारत का पहला पनडुब्बी रोधी उथले जल युद्धपोत

d) AI तकनीक से युक्त भारत का पहला युद्धपोत

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.31) 'राष्ट्रीय विनिर्माण मिशन' के संबंध में निम्नलिखित कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?

1. यह लघु, मध्यम और बड़े उद्योगों को शामिल करता है।
2. यह क्लीन टेक विनिर्माण को समर्थन देगा।
3. यह श्रम-प्रधान क्षेत्रों में रोजगार के अवसरों को बढ़ावा देने में सहायक होगा।

नीचे दिए गए कूट का उपयोग करके सही उत्तर चुनिए।

a) केवल 1

b) केवल 2

c) केवल 1 और 2

d) 1, 2 और 3

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.32) वित्तीय क्षेत्र के संदर्भ में 'बैंकाश्योरेंस' शब्द का क्या अर्थ है?

a) ऐसा समझौता जिसके अंतर्गत बैंक बीमा कंपनियों को जोखिम वहन के लिए ऋण प्रदान करते हैं।

b) बैंकों और बीमा कंपनियों के बीच साझेदारी, जिसके अंतर्गत बैंक शाखाओं के माध्यम से बीमा उत्पादों की बिक्री की जाती है।

c) ऐसी योजना जिसमें बीमा कंपनियां बैंकों की तरह समय जमा सेवाएं प्रदान करती हैं।

d) पुनर्बीमा की ऐसी प्रक्रिया जिसमें कोई बैंक दिवालिया बीमा कंपनी की देनदारियां अपने ऊपर ले लेता है।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.33) 'ब्रेसे का विरोधाभास' का सबसे उपयुक्त वर्णन निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा है?

a) शहरी क्षेत्रों में यातायात जाम कम करने के लिए सड़क क्षमता बढ़ाने से कभी-कभी कुल यातायात जाम और बढ़ सकता है।

b) उत्पादन बढ़ाने के लिए औद्योगिक क्षेत्रों का विस्तार करने से सीमित संसाधनों की प्रतिस्पर्धा के कारण कुल औद्योगिक उत्पादन घट सकता है।

c) तकनीकी प्रगति जो किसी संसाधन को सस्ता या अधिक दक्ष बनाती है, अक्सर उस संसाधन की मांग में वृद्धि कर देती है।

d) प्राकृतिक संसाधनों से समृद्ध देशों में कभी-कभी धीमी आर्थिक वृद्धि और कमजोर संस्थाएँ देखने को मिलती हैं।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.34) भारत में अनुसंधान एवं विकास व्यय के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. भारत का सकल अनुसंधान एवं विकास व्यय (GERD) का GDP के प्रतिशत के रूप में मान 1 प्रतिशत से कम है।

II. भारत के कुल अनुसंधान एवं विकास व्यय का 75 प्रतिशत से अधिक निजी क्षेत्र द्वारा किया जाता है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I

b) केवल II

c) I और II दोनों

d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.35) Consider the following pairs regarding military exercises in news:

Military Exercise	Participating Countries
I. Dharma Guardian	India and Japan
II. EKUVERIN	India and Maldives
III. Cyclone	India and United Kingdom

How many of the above given pairs are correctly matched?

a) Only one
b) Only two
c) All the three
d) None

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.36) With reference to the National Road Safety Board (NRSB) in India, consider the following statements:

I. It has been established under the provisions of the Motor Vehicles (Amendment) Act, 2019.
II. It has the authority to enforce road safety standards and impose penalties for non-compliance of these standards.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.37) Sometimes seen in the news, the Cape Town Convention (2001), primarily deals with which of the following?

a) International regulation of cross-border commercial aircraft greenhouse gas emissions.
b) Facilitate asset-based financing and leasing of high-value mobile equipment like aircraft, helicopters, and aircraft engines.
c) Establishment of a global mechanism for investigation of international aviation accidents.
d) Regulation of maritime shipping routes and safety standards in international waters.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.38) Consider the following description:

I. It is the world's highest railway arch bridge.
II. The structure is designed to withstand earthquakes up to magnitude 8 on the Richter scale.
III. The bridge has a design life of around 120 years and is capable of supporting train speeds up to 100 km per hour.

Which one of the following bridges has been described above?

a) Bogibeel Rail-cum-Road Bridge
b) Anji Khad Railway Bridge
c) Pamban Railway Bridge
d) Chenab Rail Bridge

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.39) With reference to PM MITRA scheme, consider the following statements:

I. It is aimed at creating large-scale integrated textile manufacturing ecosystems.
II. Under the scheme, at least one PM MITRA park is established in every state in India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.35) समाचारों में रहे सैन्य अभ्यासों के संबंध में निम्नलिखित युग्मों पर विचार कीजिए:

सैन्य अभ्यास	भाग लेने वाले देश
1. धर्म गार्जियन (Dharma Guardian)	भारत और जापान
2. एकुवेरिन (EKUVERIN)	भारत और मालदीव
3. साइक्लोन (Cyclone)	भारत और यूनाइटेड किंगडम

उपर्युक्त में से कितने युग्म सही सुमेलित हैं?

a) केवल एक

b) केवल दो

c) सभी तीन

d) कोई नहीं

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.36) भारत में राष्ट्रीय सड़क सुरक्षा बोर्ड (NRSB) के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. यह मोटर वाहन (संशोधन) अधिनियम, 2019 के प्रावधानों के अंतर्गत स्थापित किया गया है।

II. इसे सड़क सुरक्षा मानकों को लागू करने और उनके उल्लंघन पर दंड लगाने का अधिकार प्राप्त है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I

b) केवल II

c) I और II दोनों

d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.37) समाचारों में कभी-कभी उल्लेखित केपटाउन कन्वेंशन (2001) मुख्य रूप से निम्नलिखित में से किससे संबंधित है?

a) अंतरराष्ट्रीय वाणिज्यिक विमानों के ग्रीनहाउस गैस उत्सर्जन का वैश्विक विनियमन।

b) विमान, हेलीकॉप्टर और विमान इंजनों जैसे उच्च-मूल्य वाले मोबाइल उपकरणों के परिसंपत्ति-आधारित वित्तपोषण और लीजिंग को सुगम बनाना।

c) अंतरराष्ट्रीय विमानन दुर्घटनाओं की जांच के लिए वैश्विक तंत्र की स्थापना।

d) अंतरराष्ट्रीय जलक्षेत्र में समुद्री परिवहन मार्गों और सुरक्षा मानकों का विनियमन।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.38) निम्नलिखित विवरण पर विचार कीजिए:

I. यह विश्व का सबसे ऊँचा रेलवे आर्च पुल है।

II. यह संरचना रिक्टर पैमाने पर 8 तीव्रता तक के भूकंप सहने में सक्षम है।

III. इस पुल की डिज़ाइन लाइफ लगभग 120 वर्ष है और यह 100 किलोमीटर प्रति घंटा तक की ट्रेन गति का समर्थन कर सकता है।

उपर्युक्त विवरण निम्नलिखित में से किस पुल से संबंधित है?

a) बोगीबील रेल-सह-सड़क पुल

b) अंजी खड्ड रेलवे पुल

c) पंबन रेलवे पुल

d) चिनाब रेल पुल

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.39) पीएम मित्र (PM MITRA) योजना के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. इसका उद्देश्य बड़े पैमाने पर एकीकृत वस्त्र विनिर्माण एकोसिस्टम का निर्माण करना है।

II. इस योजना के अंतर्गत भारत के प्रत्येक राज्य में कम-से-कम एक पीएम मित्र पार्क स्थापित किया गया है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I

b) केवल II

c) I और II दोनों

d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.40) Section 69A of the Information Technology Act, 2000, frequently seen in the news, empowers the Union Government to:

a) Grants conditional immunity to intermediaries for third-party content.
b) Regulate digital signatures and electronic authentication methods.
c) Prescribe punishment for identity theft and cheating by personation using computer resources.
d) Block public access to information on online platforms in the interest of national security.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.41) Classification of an enterprise into public or private sector is based on:

a) number of employees in the enterprise
b) ownership of assets of the enterprise
c) employment conditions for workers in the enterprise
d) nature of products manufactured by the enterprise

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.42) Which one of the following is the primary objective of the Trade Enablement and Market (TEAM) Scheme related to MSMEs?

a) Facilitates micro and small enterprises to participate in international fairs and exhibitions for exposure to the global market ecosystem.
b) Modernize the processes, reduce wastages and improve competitiveness of micro and small enterprises.
c) Promote innovation across micro and small enterprises' value chains by converting ideas into innovative applications.
d) Facilitates the onboarding of micro and small enterprises onto the Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC).

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.43) With reference to Special Economic Zones (SEZ) in the context of Indian economy, consider the following statements:

Statement I: The Goods and services supplied by SEZ units to Indian territory outside the SEZ area are treated as imports into India.

Statement II: They are deemed to be a foreign territory for the purposes of trade operations and duties and tariffs.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I
c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct
d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.44) What is 'Unicorn Company' often mentioned in Indian news?

a) Any privately held startup company with a value of over $1 billion.
b) Any public sector company to be merged with another public sector company
c) Privatization of any loss-making State owned company
d) Any foreign multinational company doing business in India in collaboration with an Indian company

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.45) The AI Action Summit 2025 was co-chaired by which among the following nations?

a) India and France
b) France and United States of America
c) India and Germany
d) United Kingdom and France

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.40) सूचना प्रौद्योगिकी अधिनियम, 2000 की धारा 69A, जो अक्सर समाचारों में देखी जाती है, केंद्र सरकार को किस अधिकार से सशक्त बनाती है?

a) मध्यस्थों को तृतीय-पक्ष सामग्री के लिए सशर्त प्रतिरक्षा प्रदान करना।
b) डिजिटल हस्ताक्षरों और इलेक्ट्रॉनिक प्रमाणीकरण विधियों का विनियमन करना।
c) कंप्यूटर संसाधनों का उपयोग करके पहचान की चोरी और प्रतिरूपण द्वारा धोखाधड़ी के लिए दंड निर्धारित करना।
d) राष्ट्रीय सुरक्षा के हित में ऑनलाइन प्लेटफॉर्म पर सूचना की सार्वजनिक पहुँच को अवरुद्ध करना।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.41) किसी उद्यम को सार्वजनिक या निजी क्षेत्र में वर्गीकृत करने का आधार क्या होता है?

a) उद्यम में कर्मचारियों की संख्या
b) उद्यम की परिसंपत्तियों का स्वामित्व
c) उद्यम में श्रमिकों की रोजगार स्थितियाँ
d) निर्मित उत्पादों की प्रकृति

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.42) MSMEs से संबंधित व्यापार सक्षमता और विपणन (TEAM) योजना का मुख्य उद्देश्य क्या है?

a) सूक्ष्म और लघु उद्यमों को अंतरराष्ट्रीय मेलों और प्रदर्शनियों में भाग लेने के लिए प्रोत्साहित करना।
b) सूक्ष्म और लघु उद्यमों की प्रक्रियाओं का आधुनिकीकरण करना और अपव्यय कम करना।
c) सूक्ष्म और लघु उद्यमों की मूल्य श्रृंखला में नवाचार को बढ़ावा देना।
d) सूक्ष्म और लघु उद्यमों को डिजिटल कॉमर्स के लिए ओपन नेटवर्क (ONDC) से जोड़ना।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.43) भारतीय अर्थव्यवस्था के संदर्भ में विशेष आर्थिक क्षेत्र (SEZ) के संबंध में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

कथन I: SEZ इकाइयों द्वारा SEZ क्षेत्र के बाहर भारतीय क्षेत्र में आपूर्ति की गई वस्तुओं और सेवाओं को भारत में आयात माना जाता है।

कथन II: SEZ को व्यापार संचालन, शुल्क और टैरिफ के उद्देश्यों के लिए विदेशी क्षेत्र के रूप में माना जाता है।

निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा विकल्प सही है?

a) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं तथा कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या करता है।
b) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं, लेकिन कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या नहीं करता।
c) कथन I सही है लेकिन कथन II सही नहीं है।
d) कथन I सही नहीं है लेकिन कथन II सही है।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.44) भारतीय समाचारों में अक्सर उल्लेखित 'यूनिकॉर्न कंपनी (Unicorn Company)' क्या होती है?

a) कोई भी निजी स्वामित्व वाली स्टार्टअप कंपनी जिसका मूल्यांकन 1 बिलियन डॉलर से अधिक हो।
b) कोई भी सार्वजनिक क्षेत्र की कंपनी जिसका किसी अन्य सार्वजनिक क्षेत्र की कंपनी में विलय होना हो।
c) किसी घाटे में चल रही सरकारी कंपनी का निजीकरण।
d) कोई भी विदेशी बहुराष्ट्रीय कंपनी जो किसी भारतीय कंपनी के सहयोग से भारत में कारोबार कर रही हो।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.45) AI एक्शन समिट 2025 की सह-अध्यक्षता निम्नलिखित में से किस देश ने की?

a) भारत और फ्रांस
b) फ्रांस और संयुक्त राज्य अमेरिका
c) भारत और जर्मनी
d) यूनाइटेड किंगडम और फ्रांस

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Directions for the following 2 (two) items:
Read the following passage and answer the items that follow the passages. Your answers to these items should be based on the passages only

Passage - 1

When a state underinvests in its own defence, it does not buy peace; it invites coercion. A weak India would encourage risk-taking by those who believe they can push New Delhi. The purpose of rise in India's defence spending is to avoid that trap. It is to ensure that no adversary believes it can achieve a quick decisive advantage against India can be gained. It should therefore not be seen as escalatory measure but as an insurance. This is because deterrence is not a matter of goodwill or diplomatic engagement. It is a material condition rooted in capability. An adversary is deterred only when it believes that aggression will fail or cost more than it is worth.

Q.46) Which one of the following statements best reflects the most logical, rational and pragmatic message conveyed by the author of the passage?

a) An increase in defence expenditure is often misinterpreted as an escalatory move.
b) Good diplomatic relations alone may not always be sufficient to ensure national security.
c) Investing in credible deterrence helps strengthen India's long-term security.
d) Inadequate defence infrastructure can encourage adversaries to take advantage of vulnerabilities.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.47) With reference to the above passage, the following assumptions have been made:

I. Low investment in defence infrastructure does not always guarantee peace.
II. Geopolitical tensions in India's neighbourhood prompt the need for a strong defence structure.

Which of the above assumptions is/are valid?

a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.48) There are four bells which ring at an interval of 40 minutes, 50 minutes, 60 minutes and 90 minutes respectively. If all of them ring at 9 A.M, how many more times will they ring together in the next 72 hours?

a) 0
b) 1
c) 2
d) 3

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.49) What is the remainder when $(3^1 + 3^2 + 3^3 + 3^4 + ... + 3^{80})$ is divided by 10?

a) 0
b) 2
c) 5
d) 8

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.50) Replace the incorrect term by the correct term in the given sequence
3, 2, 7, 4, 13, 10, 21, 18, 31, 28, 43, 40
where odd terms and even terms follow the same pattern.

a) 0
b) 1
c) 3
d) 6

100%		75%		50%		0%	

निम्नलिखित दो प्रश्नांशों के लिए निर्देश:
निम्नलिखित परिच्छेद को पढ़ें और परिच्छेद के बाद दिए गए प्रश्नों के उत्तर दें। आपके उत्तर केवल परिच्छेद पर आधारित होने चाहिए।

परिच्छेद - 1

जब कोई देश अपने रक्षा क्षेत्र में कम निवेश करता है, तो वह शांति नहीं खरीदता; बल्कि दबाव को आमंत्रित करता है। एक कमजोर भारत उन लोगों को जोखिम लेने के लिए प्रोत्साहित करेगा जो मानते हैं कि वे नई दिल्ली को चुनौती दे सकते हैं। भारत के रक्षा खर्च में वृद्धि का उद्देश्य इस जाल से बचना है। इसका उद्देश्य यह सुनिश्चित करना है कि कोई भी शत्रु यह न माने कि वह भारत के विरुद्ध शीघ्र निर्णायक लाभ प्राप्त कर सकता है। इसलिए इसे आक्रामक उपाय के रूप में नहीं, बल्कि एक सुरक्षा कवच के रूप में देखा जाना चाहिए। ऐसा इसलिए है क्योंकि प्रतिरोध सद्भावना या राजनयिक जुड़ाव का मामला नहीं है। यह क्षमता पर आधारित एक भौतिक स्थिति है। कोई शत्रु तभी विचलित होता है जब उसे विश्वास हो कि आक्रामकता विफल होगी या उसे प्राप्त लाभ की अपेक्षा अधिक कीमत चुकानी पड़ेगी।

Q.46) निम्नलिखित में से कौन सा कथन इस परिच्छेद के लेखक द्वारा व्यक्त किए गए सबसे तार्किक, तर्कसंगत और व्यावहारिक संदेश को सर्वोत्तम रूप से दर्शाता है?

a) रक्षा व्यय में वृद्धि को अक्सर एक आक्रामक कदम के रूप में गलत समझा जाता है।
b) राष्ट्रीय सुरक्षा सुनिश्चित करने के लिए केवल अच्छे राजनयिक संबंध ही हमेशा पर्याप्त नहीं हो सकते।
c) विश्वसनीय प्रतिरोध में निवेश भारत की दीर्घकालिक सुरक्षा को मजबूत करने में सहायक होता है।
d) अपर्याप्त रक्षा अवसंरचना शत्रुओं को कमजोरियों का लाभ उठाने के लिए प्रोत्साहित कर सकती है।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.47) उपर्युक्त परिच्छेद के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित धारणाएँ बनाई गई हैं:

I. रक्षा अवसंरचना में कम निवेश हमेशा शांति की गारंटी नहीं देता।
II. भारत के पड़ोस में भू-राजनीतिक तनाव एक मजबूत रक्षा संरचना की आवश्यकता को प्रेरित करता है।

उपर्युक्त धारणाओं में से कौन सी मान्य है/हैं?

a) केवल I
b) केवल II
c) I और II दोनों
d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.48) चार घंटियाँ हैं जो क्रमशः 40 मिनट, 50 मिनट, 60 मिनट और 90 मिनट के अंतराल पर बजती हैं। यदि ये सभी घण्टियाँ सुबह 9 बजे बजती हैं, तो अगले 72 घंटों में वे कितनी बार एक साथ बजेंगी?

a) 0
b) 1
c) 2
d) 3

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.49) $(3^1 + 3^2 + 3^3 + 3^4 + \ldots + 3^{80})$ को 10 से भाग देने पर शेषफल क्या होगा?

a) 0
b) 2
c) 5
d) 8

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.50) दिए गए अनुक्रम में गलत पद को सही पद से प्रतिस्थापित कीजिए:

3, 2, 7, 4, 13, 10, 21, 18, 31, 28, 43, 40

जहां विषम और सम पद एक ही पैटर्न का पालन करते हैं।

a) 0
b) 1
c) 3
d) 6

100%		75%		50%		0%	

SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK

Q.1) Consider the following airports:
1. Donyi Polo Airport
2. Kushinagar International Airport
3. Vijayawada International Airport
In the recent past, which of the above have been constructed as Greenfield project?
a) 1 and 2 only
b) 2 and 3 only
c) 1 and 3 only
d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
Since 2019, **6 Greenfield airports** namely, Kalaburagi, Orvakal (Kurnool) (project cost Rs. 187 crore), Sindhudurg, **Itanagar, Kushinagar** and Mopa have been operationalised, out of which Kushinagar and Mopa airports are International airports.
Option 1 is correct. Donyi Polo Airport, Itanagar is the first **greenfield airport** in Arunachal Pradesh, has been developed in an area of over 690 acres.
Option 2 is correct. Kushinagar International Airport, is a greenfield airport.
Option 3 is incorrect. Vijayawada International airport is not a greenfield project.
Source: UPSC CSE Pre 2024
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Infrastructure
Subtopic:)

Q.2) With reference to Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) Sector, consider the following statements:
I. Globally, MSMEs are responsible for over 50 per cent of the total global employment.
II. In India, MSMEs are the second-largest employer after agriculture
III. In India, MSMEs contribute to over 45% of the country's exports.
Which of the statements given above are correct?
a) I and II only
b) I, II and III
c) I and III only
d) II and III only

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer
Statement I is correct: Globally, Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) make up about 90 per cent of businesses **and are responsible for over 50 per cent of the total global employment.**
Statement II is correct: In India, with over 7.47 crore enterprises employing over 32.82 crore persons, **the** Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) **sector holds its position as the second-largest employer after agriculture**
Statement III is correct: Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) form the backbone of India's industrial economy, accounting for approximately 35.4 per cent of manufacturing, **around 48.58 per cent of exports,** and 31.1 per cent of GDP in the country.
Source:) https://www.indiabudget.gov.in/economicsurvey/doc/eschapter/echap08.pdf - page no 325
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressNoteDetails.aspx?ModuleId=3&NoteId=154772&reg=3&lang=2#:~:text=Introduction,entrepreneurship%20and%20employment%20across%20India.
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Indian Industry
Subtopic:)

Q.3) The Backward Value Added in Exports (BVAX) ratio measures:
a) the share of exported components in gross import.

b) the share of total domestic value added in gross exports.
c) the share of foreign value added in gross exports.
d) the share of total value of agricultural raw materials in gross exports.

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Backward participation in global value chains (GVCs), commonly measured through the **Backward Value Added in Exports (BVAX) ratio**, indicates the **extent to which a country's exports rely on imported intermediate inputs.** In other words, the **BVAX ratio represents the share of foreign value added embodied in a country's gross exports.**
Following trade liberalisation in the 1990s, **India witnessed a significant rise in backward GVC integration**. The BVAX ratio increased from 10.7 per cent in 1995 to 25.5 per cent in 2012, reflecting greater use of imported inputs in export production. However, it moderated to 17.2 per cent by 2020.
Source:) https://www.indiabudget.gov.in/economicsurvey/doc/eschapter/echap08.pdf - page no 333
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Economic Survey 2025-26
Subtopic:)

Q.4) Which of the following statements best describes the term 'servicification' in the manufacturing sector?
a) The process of replacing manual labor in production lines with automated robotic services.
b) The increasing utilization of services in manufacturing production and post-production value addition.
c) The gradual replacement of the traditional manufacturing activities by the service sector.
d) The outsourcing of the core manufacturing activities to the foreign countries.

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
The servicification of manufacturing means that the manufacturing sector is increasingly relying on services, whether as inputs, as activities within firms or as output sold bundled with goods. **Manufacturing increasingly relies on services as inputs (such as R&D, logistics, finance, design and IT), and as outputs bundled with goods (such as maintenance, software support, and after-sales services).**
The phenomenon is closely linked to global value chains (GVCs), as services such as transport, communication, coordination, and financial intermediation enable the functioning and fragmentation of production across countries.
An important dimension of servicification is the expansion of in-house service activities within manufacturing firms. These functions qualify as services because, if outsourced, they would be classified under service industries.
Source:)
https://www.indiabudget.gov.in/budget2025-26/economicsurvey/doc/eschapter/echap08.pdf (Page 221)
https://www.thehindu.com/business/rising-servicification-of-manufacturing-makes-wage-growth-comparisons-tough/article69251742.ece
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Indian Industry
Subtopic:)

Q.5) With reference to India's steel sector, consider the following statements:
Statement I: India is the world's second-largest producer of crude steel.
Statement II: India is self-sufficient in iron ore and coking coal, which are primary raw materials used in crude steel production.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?
a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I
c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct
d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

Ans) c

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement I is correct: The steel sector serves as the backbone of industrialisation and infrastructure, securing **India's position as the world's second-largest crude steel producer with 152 Million Tonne of steel production in 2024-25**.

Statement II is incorrect: The three basic materials used steel making are iron ore, limestone and coke coal. **While India is largely self-sufficient in iron ore, it remains heavily dependent on imports of coking coal. Therefore, India cannot be considered self-sufficient in both iron ore and coking coal.**

Source:) https://www.indiabudget.gov.in/economicsurvey/doc/eschapter/echap08.pdf - Page 300
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Indian Industry
Subtopic:)

Q.6) Consider the following ports:
I. Jawaharlal Nehru Port, Maharashtra
II. V. O. Chidambaranar Port, Tamil Nadu
III. Vizhinjam International Seaport, Kerala
Presently, which of the above is/are deepwater Container Transhipment Port in India?
a) I only
b) II and III only
c) III only
d) I, II and III

Ans) c

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Option III is correct: Vizhinjam International Seaport in Kerala, is India's first dedicated deepwater container transhipment hub. Vizhinjam Port is a strategic maritime project near Thiruvananthapuram in Kerala. This is the **first Greenfield port project in India, initiated by a state Government**. Developed under the **Public Private Partnership** (PPP) mode, it stands as one of the largest initiatives in the country's port sector. Vizhinjam's strategic location near international shipping routes **significantly reduces transit times for vessels**, making it a pivotal point for maritime trade. As one of India's few natural deep-water ports, it can efficiently accommodate large cargo and container ships.

Options I and II are incorrect: Neither the **Jawaharlal Nehru Port** nor the **V. O. Chidambaranar Port** presently is a deepwater container transhipment port in India.

Source:) https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleaseIframePage.aspx?PRID=2032811&reg=3&lang=2
https://indianexpress.com/article/business/pm-modi-vizhinjam-port-india-first-transshipment-hub-9978092/
https://vizhinjamport.in/
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Infrastructure
Subtopic:)

Q.7) With reference to the 'Orange Economy', recently seen in the news, consider the following activities:
I. Animation and Visual Effects (VFX)
II. Traditional tribal crafts and handloom
III. Poultry processing through automation
IV. Live Music Concerts
Which of the above activities are considered as part of the Orange Economy?
a) I, II and IV only
b) I and IV only
c) II and III only
d) I, II, III and IV

Ans) a

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

The **Orange Economy** refers to economic activities based on **creativity, culture, and intellectual property**. It includes sectors where the main value comes from **ideas, artistic expression, cultural heritage, and creative content**, such as media, design, music, films, crafts, and digital creative industries.

Statement I is correct. Animation and Visual Effects (VFX) is **part of the Orange Economy** because it is a creative industry.

Statement II is correct. Traditional tribal crafts and handloom are **also part of the Orange Economy** as they represent **cultural heritage and artistic craftsmanship**.

Statement III is incorrect. Poultry processing through automation is **not part of the Orange Economy**. It belongs to the **agriculture and food-processing sector**, where value is created mainly through industrial processing and production technology rather than cultural or creative content.

Statement IV is correct. Live Music Concerts are **included in the Orange Economy** because they belong to the **creative and entertainment industries**.

Knowledge Base: **Poultry processing** is a key component of India's "**Pink Revolution,**" which focuses on the modernization, mechanization, and technological advancement of the meat and poultry processing industry.

Source:) https://www.indiabudget.gov.in/economicsurvey/doc/eschapter/echap07.pdf (Pg: 28)8
https://www.hindustantimes.com/ht-insight/economy/orange-future-how-micro-influencers-are-redefining-india-s-creative-economy-101772377352867.html

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) Sectors of Economy

Subtopic:)

Q.8) With reference to the Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF), consider the following statements:

I. It is a statutory body.

II. It acts as an apex body to provide high-level strategic direction of scientific research in the country as per recommendations of the National Education Policy.

III. Research, Development and Innovation Fund (RDIF) is a Special Purpose Fund under ANRF

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I and III only

b) II only

c) II and III only

d) I, II and III

Ans) d

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

Statement I is correct. The Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF) is a **statutory body**, established through an Act of Parliament, the ANRF Act, 2023.

Statement II is correct. ANRF functions as the **apex strategic institution** for guiding **scientific research**, innovation funding, and ecosystem coordination in India **acting in accordance with the recommendations of the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020**. It supports academia, industry, and research institutions through grants, mission-mode programmes, and technology translation initiatives

Statement III is correct: Research, Development and Innovation Fund (RDIF) is a flagship initiative under the Department of Science and Technology (DST), Government of India. It **is a special-purpose fund under Anusandhan National Research Foundation.**

Source:) https://anrfonline.in/ANRF/About?HomePage=New
https://rdifund.anrf.gov.in/
https://www.indiabudget.gov.in/economicsurvey/doc/eschapter/echap08.pdf (Page 317)

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) Economic Survey 2025-26

Subtopic:)

Q.9) Consider the following statements:
Statement I: Investments made by mutual funds in units of Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs) are classified as equity-related instruments.
Statement II: REIT units represent direct ownership of immovable property, similar to purchasing physical real estate.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?
a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct, but Statement II does not explain Statement I
c) Statement I is correct, but Statement II is not correct
d) Statement I is not correct, but Statement II is correct

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
A Real Estate Investment Trust (REIT) is an investment vehicle that allows investors to invest in **income-generating real estate assets** such as office buildings, malls, and warehouses **without directly purchasing property**. REIT units are traded on stock exchanges and provide returns mainly through rental income and capital appreciation.
Statement I is correct. SEBI recently decided that **investments by Mutual Funds and Specialised Investment Funds (SIFs) in REITs** will be treated as **equity-related instruments,** which is expected to ease participation constraints and potentially improve secondary market liquidity.
Statement II is incorrect. Investors who buy REIT units **do not directly own the underlying real estate property**. Instead, they own **units of a trust that holds and manages the real estate assets**. The trust manages the properties and distributes a portion of the rental income to unit holders.
Source:) https://www.indiabudget.gov.in/economicsurvey/doc/eschapter/echap09.pdf (Pg: 343)
https://investor.sebi.gov.in/understanding_reit_invit.html
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Economic Survey 2025-26
Subtopic:)

Q.10) In the context of defence technology, Sonobuoys, recently seen in the news, are:
a) Unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs) designed for coastal surveillance.
b) Electro-mechanical acoustic devices used for detecting submarines.
c) Underwater mines equipped with motion sensors for naval defence.
d) Surface-to-air missile systems deployed on naval destroyers.

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
Sonobuoys are **expendable, electro-mechanical acoustic devices primarily used to detect underwater sounds,** especially those **generated by submarines or ships**. They are a crucial component of **Anti-Submarine Warfare** (ASW), where they help navies **locate and track enemy submarines.**
Apart from defence applications, sonobuoys also have roles in:
I. Environmental monitoring
II. Marine biology research
III. Oceanographic studies
They can collect data on water temperature, salinity, and ambient noise, contributing to a better understanding of underwater environments.
Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025), Page: 35.
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Security
Subtopic:)

Q.11) Capital deepening refers to
a) going for more fixed capital per worker

b) emphasis on social overhead capita
c) constant capital-output ratio
d) increasing capital-output ratio

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
Capital deepening refers to the process of **increasing the amount of fixed capital per worker.** This involves investing in **additional machinery, equipment, and infrastructure.** Such an augmentation of capital per worker can lead to heightened productivity and foster economic growth.
Source: UPSC CDS [II] 2016
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Sectors of Economy
Subtopic:)

Q.12) Consider the following scenario in a country X - While insurance density has risen steadily to $97 in FY 2025 the insurance penetration has declined to 3.7 per cent.
The above scenario best reflects-
a) the average insurance premium paid per person in a year has increased while the percentage of insurance premiums to GDP in a year has decreased.
b) the total number of unique policyholders in the country has increased, but the value of the average premium per policy has declined significantly.
c) the average life insurance premiums paid per person in a year has increased while the percentage of non-life insurance premiums to GDP in a year has decreased.
d) The rate of growth of the country's population has exceeded the rate of growth of total insurance premiums collected, while GDP growth remains constant

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
Insurance penetration is the percentage of insurance premiums to GDP and insurance density is the ratio of premium to population, in other words, per capita premium. Thus insurance density can be referred to as the average insurance premium paid per person in a year.
As per Economic Survey 2025-26, while the insurance density has risen steadily to USD 97 in FY25, reflecting higher spending by households already integrated into the financial system, insurance penetration has stagnated and declined to 3.7 percent. This paradox indicates that while the sector is successful in 'deepening' revenue from existing customers, high distribution costs are preventing a 'widening' of the risk pool.
As the insurance density increases that means the average insurance premium paid per person in a year has increased. While insurance penetration has declined which means the percentage of insurance premiums to GDP has declined.
Source:) https://www.indiabudget.gov.in/economicsurvey/doc/echapter.pdf (page 139-140)
https://www.thehindu.com/business/insurance-foreign-direct-investment-coming-a-full-circle/article70506096.ece
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Insurance Sector
Subtopic:)

Q.13) The Government of India has consolidated 29 labour laws into four comprehensive Labour Codes. In this context consider the following:
I. Trade Unions Act, 1926
II. The Employees' State Insurance Act, 1948
III. Industrial Employment (Standing Orders) Act 1946
IV. The Factories Act, 1948
V. The Contract Labour (Regulation and Abolition) Act, 1970

The relevant provisions of how many of the above acts/laws have been consolidated into the Industrial Relations Code, 2020?
a) Only two
b) Only three
c) Only four
d) All the five

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer
The Government has consolidated 29 labour laws into four comprehensive Labour Codes.The four Labour Codes include the Code on Wages, 2019, the Industrial Relations Code, 2020, the Code on Social Security, 2020 and the Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code, 2020.
Options I and III are correct: The **Industrial Relations Code, 2020** has been prepared after amalgamating, simplifying and rationalizing the relevant provisions of the **Trade Unions Act, 1926,** the Industrial Employment (Standing Orders) Act, 1946 and the **Industrial Disputes Act, 1947.** The Code acknowledges the fact that survival of workers depends upon survival of industry. In this backdrop, it simplifies laws related to trade unions, conditions of employment in industrial establishment or undertaking, investigation and settlement of industrial disputes.
Option II is incorrect: The **Code on Social Security, 2020** incorporates existing nine Social Security Acts viz; The Employee's Compensation Act, 1923; **The Employees' State Insurance Act, 1948**; The Employees' Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952; The Employment Exchanges (Compulsory Notification of Vacancies) Act, 1959; The Maternity Benefit Act, 1961; The Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972; The Cine-Workers Welfare Fund Act, 1981; The Building and Other Construction Workers' Welfare Cess Act, 1996 and; The Unorganised Workers' Social Security Act, 2008. The Code extends social security to all workers- including unorganized, gig, and platform workers-covering life, health, maternity, and provident fund benefits, while introducing digital systems and facilitator-based compliance for greater efficiency.
Options IV and V are incorrect: The Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code, 2020 has been drafted after amalgamation, simplification and rationalization of the relevant provisions of the 13 Central Labour Acts- **The Factories Act, 1948**; The Plantations Labour Act, 1951; The Mines Act, 1952; The Working Journalists and other Newspaper Employees (Conditions of Service and Miscellaneous Provisions) Act, 1955; The Working Journalists (Fixation of Rates of Wages) Act, 1958; The Motor Transport Workers Act, 1961; The Beedi and Cigar Workers (Conditions of Employment) Act, 1966; **The Contract Labour (Regulation and Abolition) Act, 1970**; The Sales Promotion Employees (Conditions of Service) Act, 1976; The Inter-State Migrant Workmen (Regulation of Employment and Conditions of Service) Act, 1979; The Cine-Workers and Cinema Theatre Workers (Regulation of Employment) Act, 1981; The Dock Workers (Safety, Health and Welfare) Act, 1986 and; The Building and Other Construction Workers (Regulation of Employment and Conditions of Service) Act, 1996.
Knowledge Base:
The **Code on Wages, 2019** seeks to simplify, consolidate, and rationalize the provisions of four existing laws - The Payment of Wages Act, 1936; The Minimum Wages Act, 1948; The Payment of Bonus Act, 1965; and The Equal Remuneration Act, 1976. It aims to strengthen workers' rights while promoting simplicity and uniformity in wage-related compliance for employers.
Source: https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2192524&reg=3&lang=2
https://www.pib.gov.in/FactsheetDetails.aspx?Id=150483&reg=3&lang=2
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Sectors of Economy
Subtopic:)

Q.14) With reference to Indian Economy, consider the following:
I. Petroleum Refinery Production
II. Natural Gas production
III. Coal production
IV. Electricity generation

Which of the following is the correct descending order of the industries based on their weightage under the Index of Eight core industries (as of December 2025)?
a) I-IV-II-III
b) IV-I-III-II
c) I-IV-III-II
d) IV-I-II-III

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
The Index of Eight Core Industries (ICI) is compiled monthly and published by the Office of the Economic Adviser (OEA) under the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), Ministry of Commerce & Industry. **The Index of Core Industries tracks the combined and individual production performance of eight key sectors: Coal, Crude Oil, Natural Gas, Refinery Products, Fertilizers, Steel, Cement, and Electricity.** These core industries collectively account for **40.27% of the total weight** in the Index of Industrial Production (IIP).
Option I (Petroleum Refinery Production): Petroleum Refinery Products - **Petroleum Refinery production (weight: 28.04 per cent)**
Option IV (Electricity generation): Electricity - **Electricity generation (weight: 19.85 per cent)**
Option III (Coal production): Coal - **Coal production (weight: 10.33 per cent)**
Option II (Natural Gas production): Natural Gas - **Natural Gas production (weight: 6.88 per cent)**
Knowledge Base:
Index of Eight Core Industries based on weightage in increasing order is given below:

- Fertilizers - Fertilizer production (weight: 2.63 per cent)
- Cement - Cement production (weight: 5.37 per cent)
- Natural Gas - Natural Gas production (weight: 6.88 per cent)
- Crude Oil - Crude Oil production (weight: 8.98 per cent)
- Coal - Coal production (weight: 10.33 per cent)
- Steel - Steel production (weight: 17.92 per cent)
- Electricity - Electricity generation (weight: 19.85 per cent)
- Petroleum Refinery Products - Petroleum Refinery production (weight: 28.04 per cent)

Source:) https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2216458&reg=3&lang=1
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Indian Industry
Subtopic:)

Q.15) Which of the following statements are correct regarding the recently launched 'Cali Fund'?
I. It will support the actions that are aimed at meeting the objectives of Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (KMGBF).
II. At least 50 per cent of the resources of the Cali Fund will be allocated to fulfill the needs of indigenous peoples and local communities.
III. The Fund will receive mandatory contributions from private sector entities that are benefitting from global biodiversity.
IV. It will be jointly managed and hosted by the World Bank and the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN).
Select the correct answer using the code given below:
a) I and II only
b) III and IV only
c) I, II and III only
d) I, II, III and IV

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

The 'Cali Fund' was launched on February 25, 2025, at the resumed 16th Conference of Parties (COP16) to the United Nations Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD) in Rome. It has been created to help protect biodiversity.

Statement I is correct. The Cali Fund is seen as a key step towards meeting the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (KMGBF) goal of stopping and reversing biodiversity loss by 2030. The Cali Fund **aims to enhance biodiversity finance** by collecting contributions from businesses that use genetic data from nature in their products and research.

Statement II is correct. The money collected will be used in several ways. It will support biodiversity conservation projects, help developing countries implement their biodiversity action plans, and fund scientific research to improve how genetic data is stored and used.

Recognizing their role and contributions as custodians of biodiversity, **50 per cent of the resources of the Cali Fund will be allocated to the self-identified needs of indigenous peoples and local communities,** including women and youth.

Statement III is correct. It is the first global biodiversity fund under the UN to receive direct contributions from businesses benefiting from biodiversity. **The Cali Fund will receive money from businesses that rely on Digital Sequence Information (DSI).** DSI includes genetic data from plants, animals, and microorganisms. Industries like pharmaceuticals, cosmetics, agriculture, and biotechnology use DSI to develop products. Under this new system, they will now have to contribute a part of their revenue to support biodiversity efforts. Thus, it will collect money from private companies.

Statement IV is incorrect. The United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) and United Nations Environment Programme will manage the fund. The Multi-Partner Trust Fund Office (MPTFO) will handle administrative tasks.

Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025)
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Environment
Subtopic:)

Q.16) In the context of Indian economy, consider the following statements:

Statement I: Presently, India is the largest mobile phone manufacturer globally.

Statement II: Production Linked Incentive Scheme has encouraged major smartphone companies to shift their production to India

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I
c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct
d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

Ans) d

Exp) Option d is the correct answer

Statement I is incorrect: Production of mobile phones has increased from ₹18,000 crores in 2014-15 to ₹5.45 lakh crore in 2024-25, a 28-fold rise. **India is the second-largest mobile phone manufacturer globally.** Over 330 million mobile phones a year are being manufactured in India and on average there are about a billion mobile phones in use in India.

Statement II is correct: Electronics industry is the fastest-growing segment among India's top 30 export categories, and mobiles are an integral part of this upsurge. This shift majorly started with the Phased Manufacturing Programme in 2017 and accelerated with the 2020 Production Linked Incentive Scheme.
Production Linked Incentive Scheme launched in 2020 initially began with the Mobile Manufacturing and certain other sectors. It powers the national goal of Digital India by driving local production of mobile phones, and electronics, making technology more accessible and affordable. **The Production Linked Incentive scheme extends an incentive of 4% to 6% to eligible mobile companies on incremental sales of manufactured goods.** As PLI schemes can be availed by both domestic as well as foreign companies operating in India because of which a number of foreign manufacturers opened mobile manufacturing plants in India. **Thus, the Production Linked Incentive Scheme has encouraged major smartphone companies to shift their production to India.**
Source: https://www.pib.gov.in/PressNoteDetails.aspx?NoteId=155232&ModuleId=3&reg=3&lang=2
https://www.meity.gov.in/static/uploads/2024/02/Frequently_Asked_Questions_on_PLI_Scheme.pdf
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Indian Industry
Subtopic:)

Q.17) With reference to Credit Guarantee Scheme for Startups (CGSS), consider the following statements:
I. It would help in providing collateral free debt funding to eligible startups.
II. Venture Debt Funds (VDFs) under SEBI registered Alternative Investment Funds are eligible as lending/investing institutions under the scheme.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
The Credit Guarantee Scheme for Startups (CGSS) is aimed at providing credit guarantee up to a specified limit against loans extended by Member Institutions (MIs) to finance eligible borrowers viz. Startups.
Statement I is correct: This Scheme would help provide the much-needed collateral free debt funding to startups. In this regard, an eligible startup shall approach a MI and seek credit assistance under this guarantee scheme.
The broad objective of CGSS is to finance eligible startups, by **enabling collateral free debt funding to startups** through avenues such as working capital, term loans, and venture debt.
The eligibility criteria for an entity to borrow under the Credit Guarantee Scheme for Startups shall be as follows, wherein an entity should be:

- Startup as recognized by DPIIT as per Gazette Notifications issued from time to time, and
- Startup not in default to any lending/investing institution and not classified as Non-Performing Asset as per RBI guidelines, and
- Startup whose eligibility is certified by the Member Institution for the purpose of guarantee cover.

Statement II is correct: Under the Credit Guarantee Scheme for Startups (CGSS), loans to eligible startups can be extended by Member Institutions, which include Scheduled Commercial Banks, Financial Institutions, and RBI-registered Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs) that have a minimum credit rating of BBB or above and **Venture Debt Funds (VDFs) under SEBI registered Alternative Investment Funds.**
Knowledge Base:
Under the Credit Guarantee Scheme for Startups (CGSS), the guarantee cover is maximum of Rs. 20 crore per borrower, as per details given below:
i. 85% of the amount in default for loan amount up to Rs. 10 crore; and
ii. 75% of the amount in default for loan amount exceeding Rs. 10 crore.
Source:) https://www.startupindia.gov.in/content/sih/en/credit-guarantee-scheme-for-startups.html
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2127843&reg=3&lang=2#:~:text=In%20line%20with%20the%20Action,Abhishek%20Dayal/Abhijith%20Narayanan

Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Indian Industry
Subtopic:)

Q.18) In the context of India, consider the following three entities:
I. A is a private limited company established 8 years ago, engaged in the development of a localized E-commerce platform.
II. B is a private limited company established 13 years ago and spend most of its money on research and development (R&D) activities and owns a novel intellectual property (IP).
III. C is a Multi State Cooperative Society registered under Multi-State Cooperative Societies Act, 2002 established 2 years ago, providing tech-enabled supply chain solutions for rural dairy farmers.
If the maximum annual turnover of the above entities never crossed 150 crore since their inception, then which of the following entities is/are eligible to be recognized as startup or deep tech startup by Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)?
a) I only
b) I and II only
c) I, II and III
d) II only

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer
The Government of India has recently revised the startup recognition framework to further strengthen the Startup India Action Plan. The updated criterias include:

- The turnover limit for recognition as a startup has been increased from ₹100 crore to ₹200 crore.
- A new sub-category of "Deep Tech Startup" has been introduced for entities working on cutting-edge and breakthrough technologies. The eligibility criteria for this category is 20 years as the age limit and the turnover limit of ₹300 crore.
- To promote innovation-driven growth at the grassroots level in agriculture, allied sectors, rural industries and community-based enterprises, startup recognition eligibility has been extended to cooperative entities. Accordingly, Multi-State Cooperative Societies registered under the Multi-State Cooperative Societies Act, 2002, as well as Cooperative Societies registered under State and Union Territory Cooperative Acts, are now eligible for startup recognition, subject to fulfilment of other applicable criteria.

Company A: It meets the eligibility criteria to be recognized as startup as:

- It is incorporated as a Private Limited Company
- Its period of existence and operations is less than 10 years from the date of incorporation.
- The annual turnover has not exceeded Rs. 200 crore for any of the financial years since its incorporation.

Thus, option I is correct
Company B: It meet the eligibility criteria to be recognized as deep tech startup as:
It can be recognized as a deep tech company as it spend most of its money on research and development (R&D) activities and owns a novel intellectual property (IP). Thus the age limit and turnover would differ from a startup.

- Company B's period of existence and operations is less than 20 years from the date of incorporation.
- Company B's annual turnover has not exceeded Rs. 300 crore for any of the financial years since its incorporation.

Thus, option II is correct
Company C: It meets the eligibility criteria to be recognized as startup as:
Now, cooperative entities can also be recognized as Startups if they meet the other eligible criteria of startups i.e.:

- Its period of existence and operations is less than 10 years from the date of incorporation.
- The annual turnover has not exceeded Rs. 200 crore for any of the financial years since its incorporation.

Thus, option III is correct.
Source: https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2224069&reg=3&lang=2
https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/technology/indias-new-startup-rules-for-deep-tech-explained/article70610093.ece

Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Indian Industry
Subtopic:)

Q.19) Consider the following:
I. Computer software or programme
II. Cinematograph films
III. Mathematical concepts
IV. Original Literary Works
How many of the above are provided Copyright protection in India under Copyright Act, 1957?
a) Only one
b) Only two
c) Only three
d) All the four

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer
Option I is correct: Computer Software or programme can be registered as a 'literary work'. As per Section 2 (o) of the Copyright Act, 1957 "literary work" includes computer programmes, tables and compilations, including computer databases. 'Source Code' and "Object Code" have also to be supplied along with the application for registration of copyright for software products.
Options II and IV are correct: The **Copyright Act, 1957 protects original literary**, dramatic, musical and artistic works and **cinematograph films** and sound recordings from unauthorized uses.
Option III is incorrect: Unlike the case with patents, copyright protects the expressions and not the ideas. **There is no copyright protection for ideas, procedures, methods of operation or mathematical concepts as such.**
Source: https://copyright.gov.in/frmfaq.aspx#:~:text=Ans:%20No.,relating%20to%20ownership%20of%20copyright
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Indian Industry
Subtopic:)

Q.20) With reference to production of coffee in India, consider the following statements:
I. India is the world's third largest producer of coffee.
II. India produces a much higher quantity of Arabica Coffee as compared to Robusta.
III. Karnataka is the largest coffee producing State accounting for more than 50% of India's total coffee production.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) II only
b) II and III
c) III only
d) I and III

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Statement I is incorrect. India has emerged as the **world's seventh-largest coffee producer**. India's exports reached $1.29 billion in FY 2023-24, almost double the $719.42 million recorded in 2020-21. In 2022-23, India ranked as the 8th largest coffee producer globally. Brazil leads coffee production, contributing 40% of the world's supply.
Statement II is incorrect. India mainly grows two types of coffee: Arabica and Robusta. Arabica is valued for its mild, aromatic flavor and fetches a higher price than that of Robusta. **Robusta,** with its strong flavor, is commonly used in coffee blends. It **makes up 72% of India's coffee production**, making India the world's 5th largest Robusta producer.
Statement III is correct. The leading producer of coffee in India is Karnataka followed by Kerala and Tamil Nadu. **Karnataka is the largest producer accounting for about 71% of the total coffee production in India**. Kerala is the second-largest producer of coffee but accounts only for about 20% of the total production. Tamil Nadu is the third-largest producer with 5% of India's total coffee production.

Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025), Page: 40
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Economy
Subtopic:)

Q.21) Which one among the following defines flexi workers in India?
a) Formal contract staff employed through organised contract
b) Informal sector employees working in urban areas
c) Agricultural labour migrating to urban areas
d) Regular salaried workers working in registered companies

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer
India's labour market is transforming due to factors such as economic policies, technological progress, and the evolving demands of the labour market. As a result, traditional employment paradigms are yielding to hybrid models that blend contract and formality.
A flexible workforce allows employees to choose how and when they complete their tasks. A flexi worker works for a company under flexible arrangements such as short-term contracts, part-time hours, project-based roles, or through an agency without a permanent employment relationship. **Thus, flexi-workers (or flexible workers) are defined as formal contract staff employed through organized contractual arrangements rather than permanent payrolls.**
Source: UPSC CDS [I] 2025
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Sectors of Economy
Subtopic:)

Q.22) In the context of India, consider the following:
I. Legal services rendered by the lawyer in a court case.
II. Free medical service provided by a doctor in a rural area.
III. Supply of electricity by the government owned discom.
Which of the above is/are **not** included under the definition of the Services under the Consumer Protection Act, 2019?
a) I only
b) II and III only
c) I and II only
d) I, II and III

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
As per **Section 2(42) of the Consumer Protection Act, 2019**, "service" means service of any description which is made available to potential users and includes, but not limited to, the provision of facilities in connection with banking, financing, insurance, transport, processing, **supply of electrical or other energy**, telecom, boarding or lodging or both, housing construction,, amusement or the purveying of news or other information, but **does not include the rendering of any service free of charge or under a contract of personal service.**
Option I is correct: Legal services rendered by the lawyer in a court case are not covered within the ambit of definition of 'services' under the Consumer Protection Act, 2019. The Supreme Court recently ruled that legal services rendered by lawyers will not fall under the ambit of Consumer Protection Act and litigants cannot makes claims of deficiency of service against advocates. The **lawyers cannot be sued for deficiency in services under the Act.**
Option II is correct: Doctors and healthcare professionals are generally covered under the definition of "service" in the Consumer Protection Act (CPA) 2019 **if the services are paid for.** While "free" services are excluded, **paid medical care**–whether in private or government hospitals (if fees are charged)–**falls under definition of 'services' in the Act.**

Thus, free medical service provided by a doctor in a rural area will not be counted under the definition of the Services under the Consumer Protection Act, 2019

Note: The Supreme Court has recently sought responses from the Union Ministries of Health and Consumer Affairs, and the National Medical Commission (NMC) on whether medical professionals such as doctors should be excluded from the ambit of the Consumer Protection Act, 2019.

Option III is incorrect: Supply of electrical or other energy is counted as services under the Consumer Protection Act, 2019. **Thus the supply of electricity by government-owned distribution companies (Discoms) is considered a "service" under the Consumer Protection Act (CPA), 2019.**

Source:) https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/city/delhi/supreme-court-lawyers-exempt-from-consumer-protection-act/articleshow/110128055.cms
https://ncdrc.nic.in/bare_acts/CPA2019.pdf (Pg. 7)
https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/india/sc-seeks-responses-on-plea-to-exempt-doctors-from-consumer-protection-act/articleshow/128173216.cms?from=mdr
https://indianexpress.com/article/explained/explained-law/medical-professionals-consumer-court-proceedings-sc-9333641/
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Service Sector
Subtopic:)

Q.23) The Public Private Partnership Appraisal Committee (PPPAC), responsible for appraising infrastructure projects undertaken through the Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model, functions under which one of the following departments of the Government of India?
a) Department of Financial Services
b) Department of Revenue
c) Department of Expenditure
d) Department of Economic Affairs

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
The **Public Private Partnership Appraisal Committee (PPPAC)** is an apex body of the Government of India responsible for **examining and approving infrastructure projects implemented under the Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model)** in the central sector. The PPPAC functions under the **Department of Economic Affairs (DEA)** in the Ministry of Finance. The committee is **chaired by the Secretary of DEA** and includes representatives from the Department of Expenditure, Department of Legal Affairs, the concerned ministry, and NITI Aayog.
Source:) https://www.indiabudget.gov.in/economicsurvey/doc/eschapter/echap09.pdf (Pg: 344)
https://www.pppinindia.gov.in/pppac
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Economic Survey 2025-26
Subtopic:)

Q.24) In the context of Intellectual Property Rights (IPRs), compulsory licensing refers to:
a) An authorization granted by the government to someone else i.e., a third party to produce a patented product without the consent of the patent owner.
b) The patent holder through its own discretion offers third parties the license to produce, market and distribute a patented product.
c) Automatic permission to produce a patented product by anyone after the expiry of the patent term.
d) A mechanism under which a startup can register its trademark for free.

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Compulsory Licensing is the grant of permission by the government to entities to use, manufacture, import or sell a patented invention without the patent-owner's consent. Section 84 of Indian patents Act 1970 deals with Compulsory Licensing.
Compulsory Licensing is permitted under the WTO's TRIPS (IPR) Agreement provided conditions such as 'national emergencies, other circumstances of extreme urgency and anti-competitive practices' are fulfilled.
Source:) https://www.thehindu.com/business/Compulsory-licensing-in-manufacturing-may-slow-investments-EU/article60514721.ece
https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/covid-19-restrictive-voluntary-licence-compromises-access/article37598419.ece
https://www.wto.org/english/tratop_e/trips_e/public_health_faq_e.htm
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Service Sector
Subtopic:)

Q.25) With reference to Indian economy, consider the following statements regarding the royalty rate on critical minerals:
I. The Union Government determines the royalty rates on critical minerals.
II. Royalty on critical minerals is levied under the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I Nor II

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
A royalty rate is a fee imposed by the government on mining companies for extracting minerals from the earth. It ensures that the state receives an equitable return for exploiting its natural resources. Critical minerals have become essential for economic development and national security in the country. Critical minerals such as Cadmium, Cobalt, Gallium, Indium, Selenium and Vanadium have uses in batteries, semiconductors, solar panels, etc.
Statement I is correct: Under the **Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957**, the **Union Government is empowered to prescribe the royalty rates for critical minerals.**
Statement II is correct: Royalty on minerals in India is levied under the **Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957 (MMDR Act)**. The Second Schedule of the Act specifies the royalty rates for various minerals. According to Item 55 of the Second Schedule, for minerals whose royalty rates are not explicitly specified in the schedule, the royalty is fixed at 12% of the Average Sale Price (ASP).
Source:) https://www.pmindia.gov.in/en/news_updates/cabinet-approves-rationalization-of-royalty-rates-of-graphite-caesium-rubidium-and-zirconium-minerals-critical-for-green-energy/
https://www.pmindia.gov.in/en/news_updates/cabinet-approves-royalty-rates-for-mining-of-12-critical-and-strategic-minerals-beryllium-cadmium-cobalt-gallium-indium-rhenium-selenium-tantalum-tellurium-titanium-tungsten-and-vanadium/
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Infrastructure
Subtopic:)

Q.26) With reference to the Indian Ports Act, 2025, consider the following statements:
I. It establishes the Maritime State Development Council (MSDC) as a statutory body.
II. The Act empowers the Union Government to fix/decide the tariffs at both major and non-major ports.
III. Each state government will constitute a Dispute Resolution Committee to adjudicate disputes between ports including major ports.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only

b) I and III only
c) I and II only
d) None of the above

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
The Indian Ports Act, 2025 aims to transform India's maritime governance with a forward-looking, integrated framework tailored to the demands of a modern economy. It replaced the outdated provisions of the Indian Ports Act, 1908, with modern & contemporary regulations.
Statement I is correct: The **Indian Ports Act, 2025, grants statutory status to the Maritime State Development Council.** The Council will guide data collection and dissemination and transparency across ports, and advise the central government on national planning, legislative reforms, port efficiency, and connectivity.
Statement II is incorrect: According to the provisions of the Indian Ports Act, 2025, **tariffs at major ports will be determined either by the Board of the Major Port Authority or by the Board of Directors** if the port operates as a registered company. **For non-major ports, tariff-setting authority rests with the State Maritime Board** or its designated concessionaire. Further, the Indian Port Act 2025 requires tariffs and charges to be published electronically for transparency.
Statement III is incorrect: As per the Indian Ports Act, 2025, **State governments must set up Dispute Resolution Committees (DRCs)** to resolve conflicts **among non-major ports**, concessionaires, users, and service providers. **Appeals go to the High Court, not civil courts.** The Boards may also allow arbitration or other alternative dispute resolution methods. This will benefit the speedy dispute resolution.
Thus, **major ports are excluded from the same.**
Source:) https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2172354&reg=3&lang=2
https://shipmin.gov.in/sites/default/files/FINAL%20ACT%2027%20of%202015%20-%20indian%20Ports%20Act%2C%202025-2.pdf (Pages 9 and 17)
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Infrastructure
Subtopic:)

Q.27) The 'Frontier Technologies Readiness Index', which assesses countries' preparedness to adopt emerging technologies, is released by-
a) United Nations Office for Digital and Emerging Technologies (ODET)
b) United Nations Trade and Development (UNCTAD)
c) World Economic Forum (WEF)
d) Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD)

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
The 'Frontier Technologies Readiness Index' measures how prepared countries are to adopt, use, and benefit from advanced technologies such as Artificial Intelligence (AI), robotics, big data,etc. The index evaluates countries using indicators like **ICT infrastructure, skills, research and development (R&D), industrial capacity, and access to finance.** This index is published in the **Technology and Innovation Report** released by **United Nations Trade and Development (UNCTAD)**. According to the 2025 report, India improved its position to 36th out of 170 countries on the Frontier Technologies Readiness Index.
Knowledge Base:
Reports by the World Economic Forum (WEF)
1. Global Competitiveness Report (GCR)
2. Global Gender Gap Report
3. Global Risks Report
4. Future of Jobs Report
5. Energy Transition Index (ETI)
6. Travel & Tourism Development Index (TTDI)

Reports by UNCTAD
1. Trade and Development Report
2. World Investment Report
3. Technology and Innovation Report
4. Digital Economy Report
5. Least Developed Countries Report

Source:) https://www.indiabudget.gov.in/economicsurvey/doc/eschapter/echap07.pdf (Pg: 282)
https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/tech/technology/india-ranks-36-out-of-170-nations-on-readiness-for-frontier-technologies-global-index/articleshow/119965135.cms?from=mdr
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Economic Survey 2025-26
Subtopic:)

Q.28) Consider the following pairs of Airports of India and their significance:

Airport	**Significance**
I. Navi Mumbai International Airport	India's largest airport in terms of area.
II. Cochin International Airport	World's first airport to operate entirely on solar power.
III. Kempegowda International Airport	India's first airport to achieve 'water-positive' status.

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?
a) Only one
b) Only two
c) All the three
d) None

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
Pair I is incorrect. The **Navi Mumbai International Airport** is designed as a major greenfield airport for the Mumbai Metropolitan Region. One of its distinctive features is that it will be the first airport in India to be connected by water taxi services, improving connectivity through waterways in addition to road and rail transport. It is spread over 1,160 hectares (2867 Acres).
Rajiv Gandhi International Airport (RGIA) in Hyderabad is the country's largest airport by area, covering over 5,500 acres.
Pair II is correct. Cochin International Airport in Kerala became the **world's first fully solar-powered airport in 2015**. Its entire energy requirement is met through solar power plants installed near the airport, making it a global example of sustainable aviation infrastructure.
Pair III is incorrect. The **first airport in India to achieve water-positive status** was **Indira Gandhi International Airport** in Delhi. Water-positive means the airport **replenishes more water than it consumes** through rainwater harvesting and water recycling.
Knowledge Base: Rajiv Gandhi International Airport in Hyderabad was the first in India to have facial recognition system for passengers under the Digi Yatra initiative.
Source:) https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2176402&reg=3&lang=2
https://www.newsonair.gov.in/pm-to-inaugurate-navi-mumbai-international-airport-on-october-8-operations-from-december/
https://www.teriin.org/opinion/1st-airport-world-go-100-solar-india
https://www.unep.org/championsofearth/node/46
https://www.newsonair.gov.in/indira-gandhi-international-airport-becomes-first-in-india-to-achieve-water-positive-status/

Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Infrastructure
Subtopic:)

Q.29) With reference to the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI), consider the following statements:
I. It is a statutory body under the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways.
II. It has recently launched the Bee Corridor initiative to reduce the ecological stress faced by honeybees and other pollinators.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Statement I is correct: The **National Highway Authority of India (NHAI)** was set up by an Act of the Parliament, the National Highways Authority of India **(NHAI Act), 1988.** NHAI is a **statutory body under the administrative control of the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH).** Its mission is to develop, maintain and manage National Highways vested in it by the Government.
Statement II is correct: NHAI recently **launched** a first-of-its-kind **initiative to develop pollinator or bee corridors along National Highways.** The 'Bee Corridor' will have a continuous linear stretch of bee-friendly vegetation comprising flowering trees and plants that will ensure the availability of nectar and pollen throughout the year. The initiative will **help reduce the increasing ecological stress faced by honeybees and other pollinators,** which is adversely impacting pollination services, agricultural and horticultural productivity, and overall ecological balance.
Knowledge Base:
NHAI functions include:

- To develop, maintain and manage National Highways vested in it by the Government.
- To collect fees on National Highways, regulate and control the plying of vehicles on National Highways for its proper management.
- To develop and provide consultancy and construction services in India and abroad and carry on research activities in relation to the development, maintenance and management of highways or any other facilities there at.
- To advise the Central Government on matters relating to highways.
- To assist on such terms and conditions as may be mutually agreed upon, any State Government in the formulation and implementation of schemes for highway development.

Source:) https://nhi.gov.in/#/about-nhai
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2229103&reg=3&lang=1
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Infrastructure
Subtopic:)

Q.30) With reference to India's naval defence technology, the 'INS Surat', recently in the news, is:
a) India's first indigenously built nuclear-powered submarine.
b) India's first stealth frigate under Project 17A.
c) India's first anti-submarine warfare shallow watercraft.
d) India's first warship to be equipped with artificial intelligence (AI) solutions.

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
Option d is correct: INS Surat is a state-of-the-art **stealth-guided missile destroyer** and the fourth vessel under Project 15B (Visakhapatnam class).

Commissioned on January 15, 2025, it holds the distinction of being the **Indian Navy's first warship integrated with artificial intelligence (AI) capabilities.** It has a displacement of 7,400 tonnes.

Option a is incorrect: This refers to **INS Arihant**, which is **India's first indigenously developed nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine**. It was launched on July 26, 2009, and commissioned in August 2016.

Option b is incorrect: This pertains to **INS Nilgiri**, the **lead ship** of the **Project 17A class of stealth frigates**. It is the **first of seven frigates being constructed under this project**.

- Built by Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited, it was commissioned in January, 2025.
- INS Nilgiri is designed to operate in blue-water environments and can address both conventional and non-conventional threats.

Option c is incorrect: This describes **INS Arnala**, which is **India's first anti-submarine warfare shallow watercraft.**

- It is the first vessel of the Arnala-class anti-submarine warfare shallow water crafts (ASWSWCs).
- Launched in December, 2022, it was built by Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers (GRSE).
- INS Arnala is designed for coastal defense and anti-submarine operations in shallow waters.

Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025), Page: 36.
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Science & Technology
Subtopic:)

Q.31) Which of the following statements with regard to the 'National Manufacturing Mission' is/are correct?
1. It covers small, medium and large industries.
2. It will support cleantech manufacturing.
3. It will facilitate promotion of employment opportunities in labour-intensive sectors.
Select the answer using the code given below.
a) 1 only
b) 2 only
c) 1 and 2 only
d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer
Statement 1 is correct: **A National Manufacturing Mission to cover small, medium and large industries** for furthering "Make in India" was announced in the Union Budget 2025-26.
Statement 2 is correct: The **National Manufacturing Mission will support Clean Tech manufacturing** and aims to improve domestic value addition and build the ecosystem for solar PV cells, EV batteries, motors and controllers, electrolyzers, wind turbines, very high voltage transmission equipment and grid scale batteries.
Statement 3 is correct: Specific policy and facilitation measures to promote employment and entrepreneurship opportunities in labour-intensive sectors will be introduced under National manufacturing Mission.
Source: UPSC CAPF 2025
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Indian Industry
Subtopic:)

Q.32) In the context of the financial sector, what does the term 'Bancassurance' refer to?
a) An agreement under which banks provide loans to insurance companies for underwriting risks.
b) A partnership between banks and insurance companies to sell insurance products through bank branches.
c) A scheme where insurance companies provide time deposit services similar to banks.
d) A process of reinsurance where a bank takes over the liabilities of an insolvent insurance provider to protect policyholders.

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Bancassurance is a model in the financial sector where **banks and insurance companies collaborate to distribute insurance products**. In this arrangement, banks use their branch network and customer base to sell insurance policies of partner insurance companies. Bank employees offer insurance policies to their customers, and both the bank and the insurance company benefit through commissions and expanded market reach. This also provides convenience to customers by allowing them to access multiple financial services at one place.
Source:) https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/industry/banking/finance/insure/bank-assurance-sought-to-curb-misselling-of-insurance-products/articleshow/106524397.cms?from=mdr
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Insurance Sector
Subtopic:)

Q.33) Which of the following statements best describes 'Braesse's Paradox'?
a) Increasing road capacity in urban areas to reduce congestion can actually worsen overall traffic congestion.
b) Expanding industrial zones to boost production can reduce overall industrial output due to increased competition for limited resources.
c) Technological progress that makes a resource cheaper or more efficient to use often leads to an increase in demand for that resource.
d) Countries endowed with abundant natural resources may experience slower economic growth and weaker institutions.

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
Named after German mathematician Dietrich Braess, Braess's Paradox refers to a counterintuitive phenomenon in transport network theory **where adding extra capacity** (such as a new road or lane) **can increase overall travel time and worsen congestion**. This occurs because individual drivers choose routes that minimize their own travel time, leading to a network equilibrium that is less efficient for all users. As a result, the addition of new routes can paradoxically degrade the overall performance of the traffic system.
Knowledge Base:

- Jevons Paradox is the idea that technological progress that makes a resource cheaper or more efficient to use often leads to an increase in demand for that resource.
- The "resource curse" (or paradox of plenty) is the phenomenon where countries with abundant natural resources (like oil, gas, or minerals) often experience lower economic growth, higher poverty, poorer development, and more corruption than resource-poor nations.

Source:) https://www.downtoearth.org.in/pollution/bengalurus-tunnel-road-and-double-decker-road-plan-the-perfect-braesses-paradox
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Infrastructure
Subtopic:)

Q.34) With reference to Research and Development expenditure in India, consider the following statements:
I. India's Gross Expenditure on Research and Development (GERD) as a percentage of Gross Domestic Product is less than 1 per cent.
II. The private sector accounts for more than 75 per cent of India's total Research and Development expenditure.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Statement I is correct: India's Gross Expenditure on Research and Development (GERD) as a percentage of GDP is less than 1 per cent and stands at a modest 0.64 per cent, substantially below the global average. Leading economies, such as the US (3.48 per cent), China (2.43 per cent), and South Korea (4.91 per cent), invest significantly more.
Statement II is incorrect: The private sector contributes around 41 per cent of the total R&D spending in India and is considered as one of the major reasons for low GERD. This stands in sharp contrast to countries like China (77 per cent), the United States (75 per cent), and South Korea (79 per cent), where the business sector plays a much more substantial role in financing research and development.
Source:) https://www.indiabudget.gov.in/economicsurvey/doc/eschapter/echap08.pdf - Pg: 316
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Economic Survey 2025-26
Subtopic:)

Q.35) Consider the following pairs regarding military exercises in news:

Military Exercise	Participating Countries
I. Dharma Guardian	India and Japan
II. EKUVERIN	India and Maldives
III. Cyclone	India and United Kingdom

How many of the above given pairs are correctly matched?
a) Only one
b) Only two
c) All the three
d) None

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
Pair I is correct: Dharma Guardian:
- Dharma Guardian is a **bilateral joint military (army) exercise** conducted annually between **India and Japan**, held alternately in both countries.
- It is conducted between the Indian Army and the Japan Ground Self-Defense Force.
- Its main objective is to enhance interoperability between the armed forces, especially in urban warfare and counter-terrorism operations conducted under a UN mandate.

Pair II is correct: EKUVERIN:
- It is a **bilateral military (army) exercise** between **India and Maldives**.
- Ekuverin means "friends" in the Maldivian language (Dhivehi).
- It is held annually and alternately in India and the Maldives and is conducted between the **Indian army and Maldives National Defence Force**.
- It aims to enhance interoperability between the two forces in counter-insurgency and counter-terrorism operations, as well as conduct joint humanitarian assistance and disaster relief (HADR) operations.

Pair III is incorrect: Cyclone 2025:
- Cyclone 2025 refers to **the third joint military exercise between India and Egypt (not UK),** held in Rajasthan, India.
- It involves Special Forces from both nations and focuses on: Defense cooperation, Interoperability and Sharing skills in desert warfare

Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025), Page: 38.
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Security
Subtopic:)

Q.36) With reference to the National Road Safety Board (NRSB) in India, consider the following statements:
I. It has been established under the provisions of the Motor Vehicles (Amendment) Act, 2019.
II. It has the authority to enforce road safety standards and impose penalties for non-compliance of these standards.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
The **National Road Safety Board (NRSB)** serves as an expert advisory body that assists the government (Union and State) in improving vehicle safety, road infrastructure, and traffic management practices.
Statement I is correct. The **Motor Vehicles (Amendment) Act, 2019** introduced several reforms to improve road safety and regulate motor vehicle operations in India. One important provision is **Section 215B**, which provides for the **constitution of the National Road Safety Board**.
Statement II is incorrect. The National Road Safety Board (NRSB) functions primarily as an **advisory body**. It does not possess executive or enforcement powers. The Board recommends standards and guidelines related to road safety:
1. Vehicle safety standards – The Board advises on the **design, construction, weight, manufacturing process, operation and maintenance of motor vehicles**, including safety equipment.
2. Regulation of vehicles and drivers – It provides recommendations on **vehicle registration, licensing systems, and regulatory frameworks** related to road transport.
3. Road infrastructure and traffic control – It helps in **formulating standards for road safety and infrastructure planning**, including traffic management systems.
4. Technology and innovation – The Board encourages **new vehicle technologies** that can improve safety outcomes.
5. Safety of vulnerable road users – This includes pedestrians, cyclists, and other road users who face higher risks on roads.
6. Awareness and education – It promotes **driver training programmes and road safety awareness campaigns**.
Source:) https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1845883&reg=3&lang=2 ;
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Infrastructure
Subtopic:)

Q.37) Sometimes seen in the news, the Cape Town Convention (2001), primarily deals with which of the following?
a) International regulation of cross-border commercial aircraft greenhouse gas emissions.
b) Facilitate asset-based financing and leasing of high-value mobile equipment like aircraft, helicopters, and aircraft engines.
c) Establishment of a global mechanism for investigation of international aviation accidents.
d) Regulation of maritime shipping routes and safety standards in international waters.

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
The Convention on International Interests in Mobile Equipment was concluded in **Cape Town on 16 November 2001**, as was the Protocol on Matters Specific to Aircraft Equipment. The **Convention and the Protocol, was adopted under the joint auspices of** the **International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO)** and the **International Institute for the Unification of Private Law (UNIDROIT)**.
Cape Town Convention 2001 aims to facilitate asset-based financing and leasing of high-value mobile equipment like aircraft, helicopters, and aircraft engines by providing a uniform legal framework and international registration system.
The **Protection Of Interests In Aircraft Objects Act, 2025** recently passed in India is an Act to provide for protection of interests in aircraft objects and to implement the Convention on International Interests in Mobile Equipment and

the Protocol to the Convention on International Interests in Mobile Equipment on Matters Specific to Aircraft Equipment signed at **Cape Town on 16th November, 2001.**
Source:) https://www.icao.int/cape-town-convention-and-protocol https://upload.indiacode.nic.in/view-casepdf?type=act&id=AC_CEN_36_0_000010_202517_1746601226831
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Infrastructure
Subtopic:)

Q.38) Consider the following description:
I. It is the world's highest railway arch bridge.
II. The structure is designed to withstand earthquakes up to magnitude 8 on the Richter scale.
III. The bridge has a design life of around 120 years and is capable of supporting train speeds up to 100 km per hour.
Which one of the following bridges has been described above?
a) Bogibeel Rail-cum-Road Bridge
b) Anji Khad Railway Bridge
c) Pamban Railway Bridge
d) Chenab Rail Bridge

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
Option a is incorrect: The **Bogibeel Bridge** is one of India's most important strategic bridges in the **Northeast region**. It is located over the **Brahmaputra River in Assam**, connecting **Dibrugarh district in the south with Dhemaji district in the north**. It was **inaugurated in 2018** and is considered **India's longest rail-cum-road bridge**.
Option b is incorrect: The **Anji Khad Railway Bridge** is located in the **Reasi district of Jammu and Kashmir**. It is also part of the **Udhampur–Srinagar–Baramulla Rail Link (USBRL) project**, the same project that includes the Chenab Rail Bridge. This bridge is notable for a different engineering distinction. It is **India's first cable-stayed railway bridge**.
Option c is incorrect: The **Pamban Railway Bridge** is located in **Tamil Nadu** and connects **Rameswaram Island with the Indian mainland at Mandapam**. It was **opened in 1914** and is considered **India's first sea bridge**. The bridge is famous for its **double-leaf bascule (opening) section**, which allows ships to pass through the channel.
Option d is correct: The description provided in the question refers to the **Chenab Rail Bridge**.
- The Chenab rail bridge runs over the Chenab River in Reasi district of Jammu and Kashmir. It is located between Katra and Sangaldan on the Jammu-Baramulla line.
- It is the **highest arch bridge in the world**, with a deck height of 359 meters from the riverbed – making it 35 meters taller than Paris's iconic Eiffel Tower.
- **Connecting the Kashmir Valley with the rest of the country**, the bridge forms a critical part of the Udhampur-Srinagar-Baramulla Rail Link (USBRL) project,
- The bridge is designed for a **lifespan of 120 years and can support train speeds of up to 100 km per hour**. It is capable of withstanding **earthquakes up to magnitude 8 on the Richter scale, as well as high-intensity explosions equivalent to 40 tonnes of TNT**.

Source:) https://indianexpress.com/article/india/chenab-railway-bridge-all-you-need-to-know-10051700/
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2133723&reg=3&lang=2
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Infrastructure
Subtopic:)

Q.39) With reference to PM MITRA scheme, consider the following statements:
I. It is aimed at creating large-scale integrated textile manufacturing ecosystems.
II. Under the scheme, at least one PM MITRA park is established in every state in India.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only

c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer
Statement I is correct: The **PM Mega Integrated Textile Region and Apparel (PM MITRA) Scheme** is a flagship initiative of the Government of India aimed at creating **large-scale integrated textile manufacturing ecosystems**. These parks are designed to provide **world-class infrastructure, common facilities, and plug-and-play industrial units** covering the **entire textile value chain from fibre to garment production**. The scheme is expected to attract large private investments and generate substantial employment in the textile sector.
Statement II is incorrect: The Government has finalized setting up of PM Mega Integrated Textile Region and Apparel (PM MITRA) Parks at 7 sites viz. Tamil Nadu (Virudhnagar), Telangana (Warangal), Gujarat (Navasari), Karnataka (Kalaburagi), Madhya Pradesh (Dhar), Uttar Pradesh (Lucknow) and Maharashtra (Amravati).
Source: https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2151231&reg=3&lang=2
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Indian Industry
Subtopic:)

Q.40) Section 69A of the Information Technology Act, 2000, frequently seen in the news, empowers the Union Government to:
a) Grants conditional immunity to intermediaries for third-party content.
b) Regulate digital signatures and electronic authentication methods.
c) Prescribe punishment for identity theft and cheating by personation using computer resources.
d) Block public access to information on online platforms in the interest of national security.

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
The **Information Technology (IT) Act, 2000** is **India's primary legislation governing cyber activities, electronic transactions, and digital governance.** It establishes a legal framework for cybersecurity, digital signatures, data protection, and penalties for cyber offenses.
Option d is correct: Section 69A of the **IT Act, 2000 authorizes the Central Government** or any of its authorized officers **to block public access to any information through any computer resource in the interest of sovereignty**, integrity, state security, friendly relations with foreign states, or public order, or for preventing incitement to commit any cognizable offence.

- This provision is frequently invoked to ban websites or apps that are considered a threat to national security (e.g., blocking of Chinese apps).
- This provision was upheld by the Supreme Court in **Shreya Singhal vs Union of India** (2015).

Option a is incorrect: This refers to **Section 79 of the IT Act**, which provides a "**safe harbour" to intermediaries** (like social media platforms) from liability for information published on the platform by a "third party", that is, users of the platform.

- Also, as per **Section 79(3)(b),** intermediaries must remove unlawful content upon government notification to retain immunity.

Option b is incorrect: This is covered under **Section 3 of the IT act** and related provisions.
Section 3 deals with the **authentication of electronic records through digital signatures** and defines the process and technical standards for digital/electronic signatures.
Option c is incorrect: This falls under **Sections 66C and 66D of the IT Act.**

- **Section 66C: Punishes identity theft** (e.g., using someone's password or digital signature).
- **Section 66D: Punishes cheating by personation** via computer resources (e.g., online frauds, phishing scams).

Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025), Page: 13.
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Science and Technology

Subtopic:)

Q.41) Classification of an enterprise into public or private sector is based on:
a) number of employees in the enterprise
b) ownership of assets of the enterprise
c) employment conditions for workers in the enterprise
d) nature of products manufactured by the enterprise

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer
An enterprise is classified as public or private sector based on the ownership of its assets. Public sector enterprises are owned by the government, while private sector enterprises are owned by individuals or private companies.
Source: UPSC CDS [I] 2014
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Indian Industry
Subtopic:)

Q.42) Which one of the following is the primary objective of the Trade Enablement and Market (TEAM) Scheme related to MSMEs?
a) Facilitates micro and small enterprises to participate in international fairs and exhibitions for exposure to the global market ecosystem.
b) Modernize the processes, reduce wastages and improve competitiveness of micro and small enterprises.
c) Promote innovation across micro and small enterprises' value chains by converting ideas into innovative applications.
d) Facilitates the onboarding of micro and small enterprises onto the Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC).

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
Option d is correct: The **Trade Enablement and Marketing Initiative (TEAM) Scheme** was launched by the Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises **in 2024 for three years (2024-27) under the** Raising and Accelerating MSME Performance **(RAMP) Programme.** This initiative aims to empower MSEs (Micro and Small Enterprises) to access new markets, expand their customer base and boost income via Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC). It supports **onboarding Micro and Small Enterprises (MSEs) onto the Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC) network.**

- The National Small Industries Corporation (NSIC) is the implementation agency while the Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC) is the technical partner.

Source:) https://ramp.msme.gov.in/ramp/team-scheme.php
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2149385&reg=3&lang=2
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Indian Industry
Subtopic:)

Q.43) With reference to Special Economic Zones (SEZ) in the context of Indian economy, consider the following statements:
Statement I: The Goods and services supplied by SEZ units to Indian territory outside the SEZ area are treated as imports into India.
Statement II: They are deemed to be a foreign territory for the purposes of trade operations and duties and tariffs.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?
a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I
c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct
d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
Statement I is correct: Under the Special Economic Zones Act, 2005, the Domestic Tariff Area (DTA) refers to the entire territory of India, including territorial waters and the continental shelf, but excluding the areas designated as Special Economic Zones. The **goods and services supplied by Special Economic Zone units to the Domestic Tariff Area are treated as imports into India** and are subject to the procedures and regulations applicable in case of normal imports to India.
Statement II is correct: Special Economic Zone (SEZ) is a geographically delineated duty-free enclave and **shall be deemed to be a foreign territory for the purposes of trade operations and duties and tariffs.**
Statement II explains Statement I: As SEZ units are treated as foreign territory therefore all Goods and services supplied by SEZ units to DTA are treated as imports into India.
Source:) https://www.nsez.gov.in/Resources/SEZ%20FAQs.pdf
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Indian Industry
Subtopic:)

Q.44) What is 'Unicorn Company' often mentioned in Indian news?
a) Any privately held startup company with a value of over $1 billion.
b) Any public sector company to be merged with another public sector company
c) Privatization of any loss-making State owned company
d) Any foreign multinational company doing business in India in collaboration with an Indian company

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
A "Unicorn Company" refers to a privately held **startup company that has achieved a valuation of over $1 billion.** The term "unicorn" is derived from the rarity of such companies, as they are relatively few in number and have reached a significant level of valuation.

- These unicorn companies are often highlighted in the news due to their rapid growth, disruptive business models, and potential impact on the economy.
- They represent innovative and successful startups that have attracted substantial investments and have the potential to become major players in their respective industries.

Source: UPSC CDS [I] 2022
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Service Sector
Subtopic:)

Q.45) The AI Action Summit 2025 was co-chaired by which among the following nations?
a) India and France
b) France and United States of America
c) India and Germany
d) United Kingdom and France

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
AI Action Summit 2025 was co-chaired by France and India. The AI Action Summit 2025 **was held in Paris.** It brought together representatives from 60 nations to discuss the future of artificial intelligence.
The members of the AI Action Summit in Paris have launched a Public Interest AI Platform and Incubator. The initiative was launched through a joint statement titled "Inclusive and Sustainable Artificial Intelligence for People and the Planet," at the summit co-chaired by India and France.
Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025)

Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Science & Technology
Subtopic:)

Directions for the following 2 (two) items:
Read the following passage and answer the items that follow the passages. Your answers to these items should be based on the passages only

Passage - 1

When a state underinvests in its own defence, it does not buy peace; it invites coercion. A weak India would encourage risk-taking by those who believe they can push New Delhi. The purpose of rise in India's defence spending is to avoid that trap. It is to ensure that no adversary believes it can achieve a quick decisive advantage against India can be gained. It should therefore not be seen as escalatory measure but as an insurance. This is because deterrence is not a matter of goodwill or diplomatic engagement. It is a material condition rooted in capability. An adversary is deterred only when it believes that aggression will fail or cost more than it is worth.

Q.46) Which one of the following statements best reflects the most logical, rational and pragmatic message conveyed by the author of the passage?
a) An increase in defence expenditure is often misinterpreted as an escalatory move.
b) Good diplomatic relations alone may not always be sufficient to ensure national security.
c) Investing in credible deterrence helps strengthen India's long-term security.
d) Inadequate defence infrastructure can encourage adversaries to take advantage of vulnerabilities.

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Statement a is incorrect. While the passage states that rise in India's defence expenditure should not be seen as escalatory measure but as an insurance, statement a does not best reflect the most logical, rational and pragmatic message conveyed by the author of the passage as it **does not highlight why the defence expenditure needs to increase.**
Statement b is incorrect. The passage states "deterrence is not a matter of goodwill or diplomatic engagement." However, statement b does not best reflect the most logical, rational and pragmatic message conveyed by the author of the passage as it **does not state what more is needed to develop deterrence.**
Statement c is correct. It best reflects the most logical, rational and pragmatic message conveyed by the author of the passage as it **highlights the need of developing credible deterrence for ensuring long term security**. It is mentioned in the passage as "A weak India would encourage risk-taking by those who believe they can push New Delhi. The purpose of rise in India's defence spending is to avoid that trap." "An adversary is deterred only when it believes that aggression will fail or cost more than it is worth."
Statement d is incorrect. Although the passage states ". A weak India would encourage risk-taking by those who believe they can push New Delhi", statement d does not best reflect the most logical, rational and pragmatic message conveyed by the author of the passage as it **does not highlight what should be done to avoid adversaries taking advantage of India.**
Subject:) CSAT
Topic:) Reading Comprehension
Subtopic:)

Q.47) With reference to the above passage, the following assumptions have been made:
I. Low investment in defence infrastructure does not always guarantee peace.
II. Geopolitical tensions in India's neighbourhood prompt the need for a strong defence structure.
Which of the above assumptions is/are valid?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II

d) Neither I nor II

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
Statement I is correct. The passage states "**When a state underinvests in its own defence, it does not buy peace; it invites coercion**." Therefore, we can conclude that the statement is correct.
Statement II is incorrect. While the passage states that "no adversary believes it can achieve a quick decisive advantage against India can be gained", it **does not provide any context of geopolitical tensions in India's neighbourhood.** Therefore, the assumption is outside the scope of the passage and thus incorrect.
Subject:) CSAT
Topic:) Reading Comprehension
Subtopic:)

Q.48) There are four bells which ring at an interval of 40 minutes, 50 minutes, 60 minutes and 90 minutes respectively. If all of them ring at 9 A.M, how many more times will they ring together in the next 72 hours?
a) 0
b) 1
c) 2
d) 3

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
To find how many more times the bells will ring together in the next 72 hours, we need the Least Common Multiple (LCM) of their intervals (40, 50, 60, and 90 minutes).
LCM=LCM(40,50,60,90)=1800 minutes
Convert to Hours: 1800/60 = 30 hours
Determine Number of Rings in 72 Hours: 72/30 =2.4
Since we are interested in the whole number of times they ring together in 72 hours (excluding the initial 9 A.M. ring), the bells will ring together 2 more times in the next 72 hours.
Therefore, the correct answer is: (c) 2
Subject:) CSAT
Topic:) Quantitative Aptitude
Subtopic:)

Q.49) What is the remainder when ($3^1 + 3^2 + 3^3 + 3^4 + ... + 3^{80}$) is divided by 10?
a) 0
b) 2
c) 5
d) 8

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
To find the remainder when powers of 3 are divided by 10, we simply look at the last digit of each term:
3^1 / 10 = Remainder 3
3^2 / 10 = Remainder 9
3^3 / 10 = 27, so Remainder 7
3^4 / 10 = 81, so Remainder 1
3^5 / 10 = 243, so Remainder 3 (Pattern repeats)
The remainders follow a cycle of 4: (3, 9, 7, 1).
Calculate the Sum of One Full Cycle
Sum of one cycle = 3 + 9 + 7 + 1 = **20**.

When this sum (20) is divided by 10, the remainder is **0**.

Determine the Number of Full Cycles

There are 80 terms in total (from 3^1 to 3^{80}).

Total terms / Cycle length = 80 / 4 = 20 full cycles.

Final Remainder Calculation

Since there are 20 full cycles and each cycle results in a remainder of 0:

Final Remainder = 20 × 0 = 0.

Therefore, Option a is the correct answer.

Subject:) CSAT

Topic:) Quantitative Aptitude

Subtopic:)

Q.50) Replace the incorrect term by the correct term in the given sequence

3, 2, 7, 4, 13, 10, 21, 18, 31, 28, 43, 40

where odd terms and even terms follow the same pattern.

a) 0

b) 1

c) 3

d) 6

Ans) a

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

On observing the odd and the even series separately, we can see that in each of the series the next term is obtained by adding 2 extra from and to the previous term. So, the added elements are 4, 6, 8, 10 and 12. In the even term, the 2nd term must be obtained by adding 4 to the first one. So, the 1st term would be 4-4=0

Subject:) CSAT

Topic:) Logical and Verbal Reasoning

Subtopic:)

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